



NEARBY



Filled Form-7 targeting Muslims surface in Belagavi

BENGALURU
‘Already printed’ bulk Form-7 applications seeking deletion of Muslim names were received by BLOs at six polling stations in Belagavi North Assembly constituency. » **PAGE 2**

Changes in PF withdrawal rules lead to protests

BENGALURU
Garment workers of Karnataka have become restive over changes brought to Provident Fund (PF) withdrawal, which came into effect from July 1, 2026. The change allows partial withdrawal of upto 75%, a move that has been opposed by workers. » **PAGE 6**

Israel-bound plane drops 16,000 ft in a minute as pilot stabs colleague

Netanyahu hails Indian captain of Dubai-Tel Aviv flight for ‘extraordinary bravery’, says co-pilot tried to crash the plane; flydubai jet makes erratic circle close to Jordan, lands in Saudi Arabia; Defence Minister terms it a ‘terrorist attack attempt’

Associated Press
TEL AVIV

An Indian pilot on a flight from the United Arab Emirates to Israel was stabbed by his co-pilot who was apparently trying to crash the aircraft on Wednesday, Israel’s Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said. Passengers and crew subdued the attacker, and the plane made a safe emergency landing in Saudi Arabia. Captain Smit Machchhar sustained serious injuries. The flydubai flight FZ 1073 was travelling from Dubai to Tel Aviv carrying 174 people, dozens of them Israelis. Around two-and-a-half hours after leaving Dubai, the Boeing 737 MAX aircraft issued an emergency alert and descended



Passengers who were on the flydubai flight arrive at the Ben Gurion International Airport in Tel Aviv, Israel, on Wednesday night. AP

from 33,000 feet to 17,000 feet in about a minute, before making an erratic circle close to the Jordanian border and landing in Tabuk in Saudi Arabia about an hour later, according to Flightradar24. The episode prompted Israel to scramble warplanes amid concerns of

possible hijacking. Video footage circulating online shows two men on the floor of the plane, bloodied and wounded. Two people appear to be providing medical treatment, while two others guard the cockpit. “We are guarding the pilot,” one person says in Hebrew.

In another video, passengers weep and cry out in distress as the aircraft shakes. The passengers and crew who intervened “saved many lives and prevented a major disaster,” Mr. Netanyahu said, adding that the co-pilot, whose identity was not immediately shared by authorities, has been arrested in Saudi Arabia and is being questioned by authorities. Saudi Arabia had no immediate comment. Mr. Netanyahu praised Captain Machchhar for his “extraordinary bravery.” “Despite being stabbed and seriously injured, he fought back... preventing a catastrophic mid-air disaster. He saved the lives of 174 people, including Israeli citizens and other nationals,” Mr. Netanyahu wrote

on X. Captain Machchhar has been admitted to a hospital in Tabuk city and is reported to be in stable condition. Later in the day, the passengers were taken to Israel in a separate aircraft. Israel has decided to ramp up security checks on pilots flying into the country following the incident, a spokesperson for the Prime Minister’s Office said. Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz said the incident aboard the plane “was a jihadist terrorist attack attempt, which was thwarted only thanks to the bravery of several Israeli passengers who broke into the cockpit and overpowered the terrorist”.

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SC rules out total ban on fireworks for Deepavali
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Partnership can deliver across sectors, writes Ambassador of Iceland
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One killed, 12 injured in blast at MRPL unit

The Hindu Bureau
MANGALURU

One person died, another sustained burn injuries, and 11 others suffered minor injuries following a blast in the Coker Hydro-treater Unit of the Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd. (MRPL) on the outskirts of Mangaluru on Wednesday. A loud explosion was heard from the premises around noon, following which fire broke out and thick smoke was seen emanating from the refinery. Window panes of nearby buildings shattered owing to the impact of the blast. MRPL said in a statement that rupture of the cold separator operating at high pressure in the unit resulted in a fire at about 12.20 p.m. The battery limits of the affected unit



Smoke emanating after the blast at the MRPL unit on Wednesday.

were immediately isolated and MRPL’s emergency response and firefighting teams were deployed to control the situation. The fire was completely extinguished by 2.47 p.m., it said. “During the subsequent combing and inspection operations following the firefighting activity, the body of one deceased person

was found at the affected site,” the statement said. Police Commissioner Sudheer Kumar Reddy gave the name of the deceased as Manish Karkada (30) of Mulky, who was working on contract basis. “His body was found in a charred condition,” the Commissioner said. Another injured, identified as Rajesh Baptist, sus-

tained 35% burn injuries and was shifted to a hospital for treatment. According to the doctors, he is out of danger and being treated in the ICU. Eleven others, working in an office adjacent to the unit, sustained minor injuries. They were treated in the OPD, the Commissioner said. Fire tenders from New Mangalore Port Authority and fire and emergency services were rushed to the spot to assist MRPL firefighters. As many as 54 houses and eight places of worship were damaged due to the impact of the blast, according to the Dakshina Kannada district administration. People in Angaragundi, Baikampady, Kulai and surrounding areas too experienced the loud sound and tremors.

INDIA bloc to kick off campaign against CEC, SIR across country from tomorrow

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

The Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) on Wednesday announced a nationwide campaign beginning Friday against the Election Commission (EC) and the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The graded agitation plan includes protest marches at district headquarters, a march to the Election Commission, and a joint appeal to the Chief Justice of India for expedited hearings in cases related to the SIR and alleged electoral “malpractices.” The decisions were taken after a three-and-a-half-hour meeting attended by 33 leaders from 19



United voice: Leaders of INDIA bloc parties address the media after a meeting in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

political parties. Independent MP and senior Supreme Court lawyer Kapil Sibal also participated. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said the leaders had agreed to fight together. “With unanimity, everyone vowed to fight to-

gether,” he said at a press conference. While there was no direct reference to involving the Cockroach Janta Party, leaders agreed that the bloc should engage with civil society and secular parties outside the alliance.

Poll body extends SIR dates for A.P., Meghalaya

NEW DELHI
A full bench of the Election Commission convened on Wednesday, in what was the second such meeting in four days, and decided to extend the dates for publication of the final electoral rolls under the SIR in Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya. » **PAGE 11**

Notable absentees at the meeting included the DMK, which has refused to share a stage with the Congress after the Tamil Nadu election.

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City witnesses driest monsoon in decades

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Bengaluru over the last few days may have been witnessing heavy rainfall, but the southwest monsoon rainfall pattern between June 1 and September 30 reveals a different story. According to the IMD data, during this period the Bengaluru city station recorded 313 mm rainfall with a departure of -236 mm. While the Bengaluru station recorded a deficit of -236 mm rainfall between June 1 and September 30, the HAL station received 434 mm with a deficit of -29 mm. The Kempegowda International Airport received 391 mm rainfall, while the deficit for the sta-

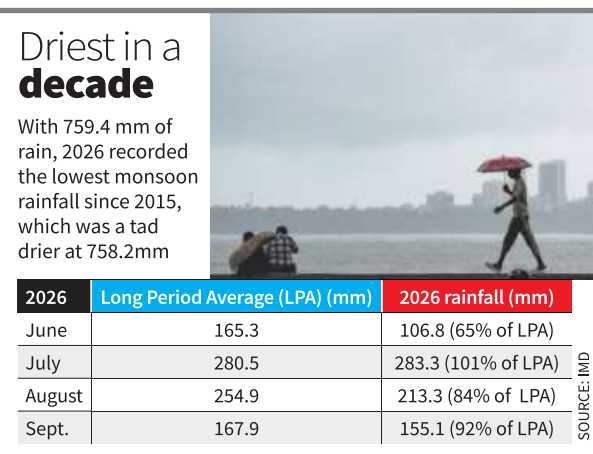
tion is not available. A post by an X handle said that the city witnessed the driest southwest monsoon in the last 20 years. “The IMD observatory at Bengaluru sees the driest southwest monsoon in 20 years by recording just 313.3 mm of rainfall against an average of 597.7 mm for the period between Jun 1st to 30th Sept. Previously the observatory had recorded 298.3 mm in the SWM season of 2006,” @BngWeather posted. Overall, as per IMD seasonal cumulative rainfall data, Karnataka received 564.6 mm rainfall against the normal 831.8 mm with a departure of -32%.

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Southwest monsoon ends with 12% deficit, October rain also likely below normal: IMD

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

India’s 2026 southwest monsoon ended with 759.4 mm of rain, 12.6% below the 868.6-mm normal, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Wednesday. At 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA), this is the lowest rainfall recorded during the monsoon since 2015, which was a tad drier at 758.2 mm. The east and northeast region, which recorded 1,017.1 mm of rainfall, had its driest monsoon since 1901, or since the IMD started to keep systematic records. The subdued rainfall was in line with forecasts by global weather agen-



cies, including the IMD, which anticipated one of the strongest El Ninos in recent history. The IMD had, since April, predicted a subdued monsoon rainfall and overall, reality corresponded to what was fore-

cast. On April 13, for instance, it anticipated the June-September rain to be at 92% of LPA, with an error window of 5%. The May 29 update lowered that to 90% with a 4% error window. The IMD’s final esti-

mate sits within this range. The southwest monsoon this year is in the process of withdrawal and is likely to completely exit within the first weeks of October, IMD Director-General M. Mohapatra said. The country will then see the advent of the north-east monsoon. With the El Nino still gaining strength, rainfall for the country in October is likely to be below 85% of the LPA of about 75.4 mm. Most regions are expected to get below-normal rain, except parts of northwest India, southern peninsular India, and isolated pockets of the east.

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LeT ‘commander’ killed in J&K: Army

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

A Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) ‘commander’ active in the Pir Panjal Valley and south Kashmir was killed in an ongoing operation in Budgam district of Jammu and Kashmir, the Army said on Wednesday. The body of the terrorist, identified as Mohammad Asif alias Hashim Moosa, was recovered along with “war-like stores” during a search in Palmaidan, the Army said, adding that the combing operation continued in the area. Officials said the killing of Moosa is a breakthrough for the security forces, as he had remained active in



Security forces keep watch in Budgam district of Jammu and Kashmir on Wednesday. ANI

central and south Kashmir for several years. They said Moosa coordinated many attacks in the region and was part of the larger LeT group active in the Kashmir Valley.

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‘FOUR KILLED SINCE 2022’
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Filled Form-7 applications targeting Muslim voters surface in Belagavi

BLOs allege they were pressured to sign, and say that two men, claiming to be from the Belagavi City Corporation, brought a bulk of Form-7 applications seeking deletion of only Muslim names

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

For the last 15 years, I have been the Booth Level Agent (BLA) here at polling station 196 in Belagavi North Assembly constituency. But last week, when I saw 380 Form-7 applications at the school, I was shocked to find my name and my brother's, along with those of our relatives and neighbours, sought to be deleted," said Meersab Sanadi, BLA at Veerabhadra Urdu Model School in Belagavi's 7th Cross, where he is also the chairman.

The incident, in which "already printed" bulk Form-7 applications seeking deletion of Muslim names were received by Booth Level Officers (BLOs), was reported in at least six polling stations in Belagavi North Assembly constituency – four in Vee-rabhadra Nagar (polling parts 194, 195, 196 and 199) and two at the Government Kannada Higher Primary School in Shettigali (polling parts 209 and 210).

BLOs at these stations told *The Hindu* that two men, claiming to be from the Belagavi City Corporation, brought a bulk of Form-7 applications seeking deletion of only Muslim names.

The voters' names and other details were pre-



In many Form-7 applications, the targeted voters' details were already printed on forms.

filled, while the objectors' names were either hand-written or left blank.

The men allegedly repeatedly told the BLOs that the applications had to be signed and returned urgently.

The BLOs, however, refused, saying they knew the electors whose names appeared on the forms as that they had been living in the area for years. When the BLOs continued to refuse, the men allegedly called someone over the phone who posed as Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) Udayakumar Basavantappa Talawar and instructed them to sign the applications.

At the same time, Mr. Sanadi returned from lunch and questioned the two men after finding his name. "When the BLOs questioned the men, they were told that such forms

SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION

had been sent to BLOs across polling stations and had to be signed urgently. The men then again called someone on the phone who posed as ERO and instructed the BLOs to sign the forms," he maintained.

Mr. Talawar confirmed to *The Hindu* that someone had falsely used his name and that he had not issued any such instructions.

Under pressure, some BLOs said they signed the forms, while others said they tried to contact their supervisors and the Assistant Electoral Registration Officer (AEROs), but could not reach them.

As the situation unfolded, the BLA said he and other local residents at the polling station contacted Belagavi North MLA Asif Sait, who was attending the Assembly session and could not be reached. They then contacted his son and Congress worker Amaan Sait.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Amaan said the men initially claimed to be from the corporation when he questioned them.

When pressed further, they said they were from Dr. Ravi Patil Hospital, he said.

He added that when some of the objectors whose details were on the

forms were contacted, they confirmed that the names and phone numbers were theirs, but said they had not filled out the applications against anyone.

"The forms could be recovered at one polling station as it was immediately brought to the notice, but that couldn't be done at other polling stations," he said.

For instance, several forms were filed in Shashikant Jadhav's name, but when contacted, he said the EPIC details and number on the forms were his, but he had not filled out any of the forms.

The trend of seeking deletions of Muslim voters' names, meanwhile, continued in Bhalki even after the claims and objections period ended on September 23, with people who had filed Form-7 applications in bulk before the deadline continuing to file applications.

The statutory Form-10 report shows 1,131 applications were received between September 24 and 29, of which 1,123 were bulk filings.

Applications filed after the claims and objections period will be taken up only after the final electoral rolls are published on October 27.

Chief Electoral Officer V. Anbu Kumar was not available for comment.

Report flags large-scale voter name deletions, ground-level discrepancies

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

An investigation report by the Anti-SIR Alliance and the Citizens' Vote Protection Committee has flagged what it describes as large-scale deletions and discrepancies in Karnataka's electoral rolls following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

The report, based on electoral-roll data, a survey of Booth Level Officers (BLOs) and ground verification across 100 polling booths in 25 districts, says Karnataka's electorate fell from 5,52,49,719 in 2025 to 4,44,53,380 in the draft roll – a reduction of about 19.5%.

The organisations have raised questions over the scale of deletions, particularly the large number of voters categorised as "shifted" and "absent".

According to the report, 65,45,679 names were classified as "shifted", 16,39,864 as "dead", 15,17,042 as "absent", 7,09,870 as "duplicate" and 3,83,884 under "others".

The report says the "shifted" category warrants particular scrutiny, arguing that people who move for employment or change rented accommodation should have an opportunity to transfer their registration rather than being removed from the rolls.

The committee also points to the difficulties faced by migrant workers who may not be present at home when BLOs conduct verification.

The Citizens' Vote Protection Committee said its house-to-house verifica-



Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar receives the SIR Scrutiny Report from a delegation of the Anti-SIR Coalition, led by actor and social activist Prakash Raj, at his Sadashivanagar residence on Wednesday.

tion found instances where voters living at their registered addresses had allegedly been marked as "shifted" or "absent". It also claimed that some living voters had been recorded under the "dead" category.

The report found that some eligible voters did not receive enumeration forms, and that several voters were unaware that their names had been removed from the draft roll.

The organisations have acknowledged that their survey covered only a small proportion of Karnataka's polling booths and called for wider verification.

Bengaluru figures

The report has separately highlighted Bengaluru, where it says the electorate fell from 1,11,16,111 to 48,48,574 in the draft roll.

The committee has questioned the scale of the reduction in a city that has witnessed substantial population growth and inward migration and has sought a detailed official explanation.

The report claimed that deletions were particularly high in some backward dis-

tricts and constituencies with sizeable SC, ST and Muslim populations.

It pointed out that women were disproportionately represented in the "shifted" category, partly because of changes in residence after marriage.

The organisations have raised concerns about the impact of the revision on nomadic communities, Adivasis, Dalits, migrant workers, Muslims and people living in informal settlements.

The report also highlighted the burden on BLOs, many of whom are teachers and Anganwadi workers.

It said 23% of BLOs surveyed received no training, while 38% of those who received training were trained for less than a day. More than 80% reportedly said they could not cope with the workload.

The report also referred to the deaths of five BLOs, which it attributes to work pressure and mental distress. The circumstances and causes of those deaths would require independent verification.

The report stated that 43 lakh voters received

notices – 23 lakh over alleged non-mapping with the 2002 electoral roll and another 20 lakh under the "Logical Discrepancy" category.

It also records 7,70,988 Form 6 applications submitted by September 24, covering both restoration requests and new voters. The committee said the figures warrant closer examination as the revision progresses.

The report has called for an independent assessment to establish the extent of any wrongful exclusion from the electoral rolls.

Speaking at the release of the report, actor and social activist Prakash Raj demanded that the SIR of electoral rolls in Karnataka be completely scrapped. He asserted that the issue extends beyond elections or political victory, alleging that an attempt was being made to "divide the country into two".

A delegation of the Anti-SIR Coalition, led by the actor, met Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar at his residence on Wednesday and handed over the SIR Scrutiny Report to him.

From Page One

City witnesses driest monsoon in decades

Among the districts Bengaluru South (earlier Ramanagara) has received the highest deficit with -87%, followed by Kalaburagi and Hassan with -55% and -53%, respectively. Bengaluru Urban district received 258.7 mm rainfall as against the normal 452.4mm with a deficit of -43 %.

IMD Officials have attributed the rainfall deficit to strong El Nino, which delayed the onset of the southwest monsoon in Karnataka.

Meteorological subdivisions

Karnataka has three meteorological subdivisions: Coastal Karnataka, North Interior Karnataka and South Interior Karnataka.

Coastal Karnataka received 2,228.3 mm rainfall as against the normal 3,093.9 mm rainfall with a departure of -28 %. North Interior Karnataka received 329.8 mm as against the normal 480.8 mm with a departure of -31%. South Interior Karnataka received 433.7 mm as against the 678.4 mm with a departure of -36 %. "As forecast, we are witnessing strong El Nino conditions which has severely impacted the southwest monsoon in the State," IMD Scientist C.S Patil said.

Rain paralyses traffic; GBA readies response teams

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Multiple spells of rain on Wednesday left traffic in the city paralysed, with travel times nearly doubling, particularly on stretches in east Bengaluru.

Traffic on the Outer Ring Road, especially near Marathahalli Junction, crawled as multiple waterlogging points slowed the movement of vehicles. The situation was further worsened by vehicle breakdowns that were reported along the ORR in the eastern part of the city.

The Panathur railway underbridge again witnessed severe waterlogging, choking traffic on the stretch.

Further, Doddanekundi Junction, Spice Garden,

Kadubeesanahalli underpass and stretches in Karthik Nagar also witnessed congestion due to waterlogging. In the northern part of the city, Vidyashilpa Road witnessed severe waterlogging due to ongoing civic works.

More than three tree-fall incidents were also reported, according to GBA sources. Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda said that the Karnataka State Disaster Management Authority has issued a heavy rain alert for the next two days. He directed the Prahari vehicle teams to remain active and conduct rounds across the city.

Mr. Gowda directed officials to ensure that control rooms remain operational round-the-clock.

Fix SH-35 within three months: KBG

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda on Wednesday revealed that the government may explore a Metro connection between Dommasandra and Hope Farm in the future, while inspecting State Highway-35 and surrounding stretches on the eastern fringes of the city.

The Minister inspected the stretch following recurring complaints, including an incident earlier this month in which schoolchildren were stuck in traffic for more than two hours.

Mr. Gowda directed the Karnataka Road Development Corporation Limited (KRDC) to fix SH-35 and surrounding stretches within two to three months, while stressing



Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda inspecting State Highway 35 on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

the need to plan road works keeping future Metro expansion and other transport projects in mind.

He acknowledged that several connecting roads to SH-35 are narrower and could pose a greater congestion threat in the coming years.

Mr. Gowda particularly ordered the fixing of the Sarjapur Road-Dommasandra-Gunjur-Varthur-Balagere corridor within

two to three months.

During an inspection of the corridor and surrounding areas, Mr. Gowda reviewed road works, drainage, traffic management, land acquisition, electricity infrastructure, and other civic works.

Considering the substantial traffic load on the stretch after Varthur Kodi, the Minister directed officials to at least start work where land acquisi-

tion for road widening has been completed.

"Even where the land is already acquired, there is debris. Clear debris, fill potholes, and damage stretches to make it motorable," he told KRDC.

Near the Varthur Lake bund, where two roads converge, Mr. Gowda noticed that no work had been carried out despite land being available. He lashed out at the engineer and directed that work be started immediately.

Further, he pointed out that several establishments between Gunjur and Dommasandra had allegedly encroached upon more than eight feet of roadside space and sought action against such encroachments. He also reprimanded officials for allowing the encroachments to take place.

IIHR's Arka Shakti root stock could help tackle GSB disease in watermelon

Rashmi Patil
BENGALURU

In what could be a boon for farmers growing watermelons across India, scientists from the vegetable science department, Indian Institute of Horticulture Research (IIHR), have developed a new and hybrid root stock called Arka Shakti. This root stock is resistant to Gummy Stem Blight (GSB), a fungal disease that is mostly seen in watermelon.

Earlier, IIHR had developed two new varieties of watermelon – Arka Manik and Arka Shyama – through their watermelon improvement programme. Now, scientists have introduced hybrid root stock Arka Shakti that can be



Arka Shakti can be used to grow existing varieties of watermelon without any fungal diseases.

used to grow existing varieties of watermelon without fungal diseases.

Sreenivasa Rao, principal scientist, said: "According to data from the Horti-

culture Department, the area under watermelon cultivation was 12,000 hectares in 2014, and reduced to 1,300 hectares in 2024. Farmers in Chamarajana-

gar, Mandya, Bidar, and Kalaburagi districts grow watermelon. The reason behind the drastic decrease in the area of cultivation is the susceptibility of

watermelon to GSB disease."

Prof. Rao further added: "Farmers get to know of the disease in watermelons only during harvest as it doesn't show up earlier. GSB is caused by a fungal pathogen *Stagonosporopsis cucurbitacearum*, and, in most cases, occurs along with Fusarium, another fungal disease. This disease spreads through seed, soil, and air simultaneously. While seed and aerial infection can be managed by chemical management, soil infection is difficult to manage. Using resistant root stocks is a good option to overcome this problem."

The scientists noted that soil develops infection when watermelon is cultiv-

ated in the same soil without any crop rotation for a long time.

He said, "Farmers can bring whichever variety of watermelon seeds they buy from the market and graft it with Arka Shakti root stock. Once grafting is done, tiny plants are kept in a chamber maintaining required temperature and light. Later, the plants are moved to the fields to grow watermelon."

Prof. Rao said: "Nurseries charge ₹6 to ₹8 for each plant. If a farmer is currently investing ₹60,000 to cultivate watermelon on one acre of land, he earns ₹2.5 lakh per acre after harvesting and selling. If grafted using Arka Shakti root stock, farmers will incur an extra ₹15,000, which is

₹75,000 per acre. However, the watermelons will be disease-free and the profits might also increase because of good quality and quantity."

He said that IIHR had cultivated a small quantity of watermelons using Arka Shakti root stock.

"The colour of the watermelon is good, unlike the faded ones available in the market. The fruit is sweet, and each fruit weighs 2 to 3 kg more than a usual watermelon," he said.

Since it is not possible for IIHR to introduce Arka Shakti commercially in a large market to farmers, they want to train nurseries from across India that are interested to learn the technique.

BWSSB calls for tenders to establish STP

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

BWSSB has called for tenders to establish a decentralised 1 MLD capacity sewage treatment plant (STP) near Tavarekere Park, following local demand.

"A significant quantity of sewage currently flows through the stormwater drain near the park. Local residents and park users have raised concerns over the resulting foul odour, fly nuisance and unhygienic conditions. The project is intended to provide a long-term solution to these issues," BWSSB said in a statement.



Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister

BDA Enters a New Era of

CITIZEN-CENTRIC GOVERNANCE

Transparency in process. Accountability in action.
Citizens at the centre.

100th Open House Meeting

1st October 2026

BDA Open House Meeting

One year ago, under the direction of the Hon'ble Chief Minister Shri D. K. Shivakumar, and aided by the vision and leadership of Shri N. A. Haris, Chairman, BDA and MLA, Shantinagar Assembly Constituency, BDA started its Open House Meetings to strengthen the public grievance redressal system with transparency and accountability at its core.

Today, BDA is the only agency in the country that live-streams its public grievance Open House Meetings, enabling citizens and the public to witness the grievance redressal proceedings first-hand.

The live-streaming of the Open House Meetings on YouTube brings greater transparency, accountability and public scrutiny to the grievance redressal process.

As BDA reaches its 100th Open House Meeting, we gratefully acknowledge the visionary leadership of the Hon'ble Chief Minister and thank the Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister for his continued guidance and support.



"The BDA Open House Meetings marks an important milestone in citizen-centric governance—where every grievance is heard, every action is accountable, and transparency remains at the heart of public service."



Dr. G. Parameshwara
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister

Public by design

Citizens and concerned officers present their cases before the BDA Chairman and Commissioner. Proceedings are livestreamed on YouTube, and scheduled citizens may participate online. The open process creates a public record of the discussion, action promised and outcome.

BDA guarantee

Resolution – or a written endorsement within 100 days, BDA will work towards resolving the grievance. If it cannot be resolved, the citizen will receive a written endorsement, enabling access to the appropriate higher forum.

BDA Guarantee brings the citizen, the responsible officers and BDA leadership onto one transparent platform.

Together, these measures make grievance resolution more accessible, transparent, and accountable.



948 316 6622
bda.helpline2025@gmail.com
@BDAOfficialGok

How BDA Guarantee Works

1

Submit



Submit a BDA-related grievance online, offline, by email, WhatsApp, helpline, grievance portal or official social-media channels. Physical petitions received through the Unified Tapal System are digitised and integrated with e-Office.

2

Register and receive GID



Documents are checked, scanned and uploaded. Every registered grievance receives a unique Grievance Identification Number (GID) for tracking.

3

Classify and route



The grievance is sent to the appropriate East, West, North or South Zone and classified as Urgent, General or Open House Meeting. If it belongs to another authority, the citizen is guided accordingly.

4

Assign a responsible officer



The grievance is assigned to the concerned department – Engineering, Town Planning, Land Acquisition, Revenue, Legal, Site Allotment or Estate Management – and to a responsible officer.

5

Verify and act



The officer may check records, conduct a site visit, coordinate with other departments and verify the facts before taking a decision.

6

Close or take further action



After action is taken, BDA contacts the citizen. The grievance is closed when the citizen is satisfied. If not, it may be taken up again.



As we mark our historic 100th Open House Meeting, the BDA guarantees unwavering transparency, swift resolution, and citizen-first development for a greater Bengaluru.



Shri N A Haris

Hon'ble Chairman, Bangalore Development Authority
& MLA, Shanthi Nagar Assembly Constituency

KPSC 'scam' proceeds traced to bank transfers, gold purchases

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Enforcement Directorate (ED), probing the alleged question paper leak in the Karnataka Public Service Commission's (KPSC) Veterinary Officers' Recruitment Examination, has traced the proceeds of the alleged recruitment scam to bank transfers, gold purchases and cash transactions after it arrested former KPSC Controller of Examinations, IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar.

The ED said its investigation revealed that candidates were allegedly made

to pay between ₹30 lakh and ₹40 lakh each, after an initial demand of around ₹80 lakh, for access to the leaked question paper and correct answers.

The agency alleged that portions of the money were collected through cash and banking channels and that candidates were also made to provide signed blank cheques and promissory notes to secure the remaining payments.

The agency said searches conducted between August 18 and 24, 2026, yielded material showing that the proceeds generated from the alleged criminal



The Karnataka Public Service Commission building.

activity were subsequently layered and utilised through various modes, including bank transfers, purchase of gold jewellery and cash payments for air travel and other transactions.

The transactions were allegedly carried out to conceal the source of the

money and project the proceeds as untainted property.

Gangwar was arrested by the ED on September 18 under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA). The agency alleged that he misused his position as KPSC Controller of Examinations and fa-

cilitated the leakage of the Veterinary Officers' Recruitment Examination question paper to Basavaraj Kannale, one day before the scheduled examination, in return for illegal gratification.

Gangwar was produced before the Special Court for PMLA cases in Bengaluru on September 21, which granted him 14 days' custody with the ED for further investigation.

The examination was conducted for recruitment to 400 Veterinary Officer posts.

According to the ED, Basavaraj Kannale, allegedly acting in connivance with

his associates, facilitated the illegal selection of candidates by providing them with the leaked question paper containing the correct answers. The agency alleged that Kannale obtained access to the confidential examination material through his association with Gangwar, who was entrusted with its custody and supervision.

The ED alleged that Kannale approached several candidates and assured them of selection. Around ₹80 lakh was initially demanded from each candidate, which was negotiated to between ₹30 lakh and ₹40 lakh.

BANGALORE DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
T. Chowdaiah Road, Kumara Park West, Bengaluru - 560 020

No. BBCL/CE/TENDER/PMC/01/2026-27 Date: 30.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GoK e-Procurement platform <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>)

The Chief Engineer, Bengaluru Business Corridor Limited, Bengaluru-560051 invites tenders from eligible consultants for the works detailed (Indent No. BBCL/2026-27/SE0002) in the table below:

Sl. No.	Name of work	EMD (Rs. in Lakhs)	Period of work
1	Project Management Consultancy services for Design Validation and Supervision of Construction Bengaluru Business Corridor (PRR-1) from NH-4 Tumakuru Road to Hosur Road in the Bengaluru City length of 68.364 km. Work includes oversight of ITS work	100.00	Till completion of the Project

Tender Schedule: (a) Availability of tender document from **01.10.2026 onwards. (b)** Last date for receiving queries: **06.10.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. (c)** Pre-bid Meeting: **09.10.2026. (d)** Last date of Bid submission: **16.10.2026 up to 17.00 hrs. (e)** Technical bid opening: **17.10.2026, 16.00 hrs. (f)** Financial bid opening: **Will be intimated.**

A prospective tenderer requiring any clarification of the tender documents or additional information may notify the Employer in writing to Employer's address indicated in the invitation to tender or through e-mail: executiveengineer.bbcpr@gmail.com; bharathballal.bbcpr@gmail.com

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
Bengaluru Business Corridor Limited, Bengaluru

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby notified that, my clients have agreed to purchase the Schedule Property from its owners: (1) **Sri.B.G.Mohan S/o late Gurunatha Rao, his son (2) Sri.Karthik.B.M, his daughter-in-law (3) Smt.Krupa.S.K, and (4) Sri.B.D.Vijayasathya S/o late B.Dattu Rao**, all are residing at the Schedule property.

Apart from the said owners, if any other person/s have any manner of claim or interest or demand over the Schedule property or any part thereof by way of sale, lease, mortgage, gift, lien, charge, trust, maintenance, easement, pre-emption or otherwise howsoever, they are hereby requested to file their objection/s (along with the photocopies of the documents on which they are relying), with the undersigned within **10 days** from the date of publication of this notice. Objection/s received thereafter will not be binding on my clients.

SCHEDULE

All that piece and parcel of the residential property bearing Municipal No.120 (old No.119, later No.120, there after Nos.120, 120/1, 120/1-1, 120/1-2 and 120/1-3, after that Nos.120, 120/1 and 120/1-1), having E-PID No.2678246703, measuring East to West: 30 ft and North to South: 108 ft, totally measuring 3240 Sq.ft (301 Sq.Mtrs), with a building thereon comprised of ground and first floors, situated at 3rd Main Road, Chamaraipet, Bengaluru - 560018, now coming under the jurisdiction of Bengaluru Central City Corporation Ward No.140 - Chamaraipet Ward, and bounded on:

East by : Property No.119
West by : Site No.121
North by : 3rd Main Road
South by : Conservancy

Sd/- S.F.Goutam Chand, Advocate
Goutam Associates
No.60, 2nd Floor, Kanakapura Road, Basavanagudi, Bangalore-560004

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public are hereby notified that my client intends to purchase the **SCHEDULE PROPERTY** from its owner **Mr.R.Ramesh Babu** son of and **Mrs.K.Chitra** wife of **S.M.Suresh Reddy** respectively.

Persons/banks/society/firm or any other body having any right, title, interest, claim or charge over the schedule mentioned property or any part thereof is hereby notified to lodge their objections/claims if any, in writing with documentary evidence regarding their manner of right, title, interest, claim or charge, within 10 days from the date of this publication to the office of undersigned, after which period my client shall proceed to purchase the schedule mentioned property on the basis that there are no objections/claims of whatsoever nature with regard to the schedule mentioned property.

SCHEDULE

Item No.1: Converted Land in Sy. No.21/1A/3 measuring 16 Guntas, situated at **Sadaramangala Village, K.R.Puram Hobli, Bengaluru East Taluk**, and bounded on the :-
East by : Sy. No.20,
West by : Road,
North by : Remaining portion of same Sy. No.,
South by : Nala and Private Property.

Item No.2: Converted Land in Sy. No.21/1A measuring 15.8 Guntas, situated at **Sadaramangala Village, K.R.Puram Hobli, Bengaluru East Taluk**, and bounded on the :-
East by : Sy. No.20 and 21/B,
West by : Road,
North by : Remaining portion of same Sy. No.,
South by : Remaining portion of same Sy. No.,

LEGAL & LEGAL, ADVOCATES,
No.32, Ground Floor, Rukmani's Brindavanam, 1st Cross, 1st Main, Subramani Layout, Ramamurthy Nagar, Vijayapura, Bengaluru-560016
Mob: 9900111844, 7406234888.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public are informed that our client has entered into an agreement of sale in respect of **Site No.3687**, bearing **Bangalore Central City Corporation No.3687, ePID No.5722290351**, Ward No: 112 - Domlur, Bangalore, measuring East to West 13.45 meters or 44.1 ft and North to South 9.15 meters or 30 feet, in all measuring 123 Square meters or 1324 Sq.ft, along with the building constructed thereon, totally measuring 2702 sq. feet, situated at **9th Cross Road, 13th D Main, Indiranagar, HAL 2nd Stage, Bangalore 560 008**, and bounded on the:

East by : Site No 3680,
West by : Road;
North by : Site No 3686;
South by : Site No 3688.

from its owners **Mrs.N.Vijayalakshmi Mrs.A.Manjula Thilak Naidu and Mrs.A.Monika.**

Persons having any right over the said property may lodge their objections / claims with documentary evidence within **10 days** from the date of this publication, to the undersigned.

K. V. Narendra & Associates, Advocates
No.557, 2nd Floor, 9th A Main, Indiranagar, Bangalore - 560038.
Ph: 9945109229 / 9448212853

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client **Sri. M. LOKANADHA NAIDU AND Smt. SARITHA**, have entered into a Memorandum of Understanding agreeing to develop the schedule Property by entering into a joint development agreement with **Smt. C.LALITHA**, D/o. Late. Sri.Chandrappa, Aged about 44 Years, Residing at: Venugopala Swamy Temple Road, 18th Ward, Devanahalli, Bengaluru Rural-562110. AADHAAR: 3436 9325 3810.

Any person/banking institutions/company, etc., has got any sort of legal right, claim, interest over the schedule property or having any sort of objection for the said sale transaction, shall approach the under mentioned Advocate within **7 days** from this day, with documentary evidence, failing which my client shall proceed further in accordance with the terms of the Memorandum of Understanding considering there is no objection to the said development of the Schedule property.

SCHEDULE PROPERTY

All that piece and parcel of undeveloped immovable of immovable **Site No.23**, Village assessment No. 4411, PID No. 44/1/23, Situated at, **Ganapathipura 11th, Ganapathipura and Supraja Nagar, Bangalore** Measuring East to west: 30 feet and North to South 55.0 feet, totally measuring **1650 Sq ft**, and presently within the administrative Jurisdiction of BBMP/IGBA Ward No. 197, having PID No.2402337967 AND **BOUNDED**

East by: Site No.22, West by: Site No.24, North by: Private Property, South by: Road,

N.S. SHIVASHANKAR, Advocate
No. 207, Ground Floor, 26th Cross, Behind BWSB Office, Uttarahalli- Kengeri Main Road, Poorna Pragna Nagar, Bengaluru-560061. Ph No. 93430 94442, 98459 31901

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. SBC-PRNT-PCV-QQ-CABLE, Dt:23.09.2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following works:

Name of the work	Approx. Value
Bengaluru Division- Replacement of Six Quad cable between PRNT-PVC section of Bengaluru Division	Rs.32.25,068.77

Last Date of Submission of bids: **Up to 11:00 hrs. on 15.10.2026**

For details log on : www.ireps.gov.in

Senior Divisional Signal and Telecommunication Engineer, Bengaluru

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f South Western Railway - SWR @ SWRRLY @ SWRALWAYHQ @ sw_railways

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. EPC-SBC-DMM-PSI-01 dated 17/09/2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, Invites E-Tenders for the following works:

Item of work	Approx. Value
Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 2x25 KV Auto-Transformer (AT) Feeding System, including 220/55 kV Makkaipalli (MKJ) Traction Substations, Dharmavaram (DMM) Sectioning Posts (SPs), Nagasamudram (NGM) and Penukonda (PKD) Sub- Sectioning Posts (SSPs), in Bangalore-Dharmavaram Section in Bangalore Division of South Western Railway.	Rs.75,73,56,497.32

Last Date of Submission of bids: **Up to 15:00 hrs. on 02.11.2026**

For details log on : www.ireps.gov.in

Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer/Project/ Bengaluru

Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

f South Western Railway - SWR @ SWRRLY @ SWRALWAYHQ @ sw_railways

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public are informed that my client "Mr. Jeevan C.P, Aged about 26 years **S/o. Mr.C.K.Prakash**, Residing at # No.235, 1st Main Road, Garden Road, Near Balaji Medical, Nayandahalli, Bangalore South Taluk, Bangalore - 560 039 intends to purchase the **Property No.31, Assessment No.10773, Khatha No.234, old Property No.1081/1/2B/288/387107/231, new EPID No.6543295953**, measuring East to West 27 feet and North to South 27 feet, totally measuring 729 Square feet, along with building, situated at **Lakshminipura Village, Dasanapura Hobli, present Madanayakanahalli CMC, Bangalore North Taluk** and bounded as follows:

East by : Road,
West by : Property belongs to Sri.Venkatesh, North by : Property No.30,
South by : Southern portion of property

No.31, belongs to Smt.Shashikala.

From its owner **Mr. Tejas G. Bhat S/o. Late Gururaj Bhat M.** Aged about 28 years, Residing at # 31, Vinayaka Layout, Near Pachai Anjaneya Temple Road, Lakshminipura, Dasanapura Hobli, Bangalore North Taluk, Bangalore - 560162.

Persons having any right over the said property may lodge their objections/claims with documentary evidence within **15 days** from the date of this notice, failing which it would be presumed that there are no claims over the said property.

M.V.J. Law Chambers, Jayalakshmi M.V. Advocate
No.192/6, 3rd Floor, West of Chord Road, 1st Block 2nd Stage, Rajajinagar, Mahalakshmiapuram, Bangalore - 560 096, Mobile No. 9539305787. Email - mjvlawchambers@gmail.com. Place : Bangalore Date : 01-10-2026

TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED
Kagithapuram - 639 136, Karur District, Tamil Nadu

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Notice Inviting Expression of Interest (EOI)

Tender No.	Material Description	Due Date
SI.No.1	Rebuild of Chemical Bagasse plant with upgraded technology for optimizing the reject handling system to reduce utility and power consumption by running 600TPD of unbleached chemical bagasse pulp production in Single Street and reducing weak black liquor generation.	26.10.2026

TNPL Invites Tender for the Following:

Tender No.	Material Description	Due Date
262713 004173	Procurement of Alkaline Sizing Chemicals with Alky Ketene Dimer (AKD) for PM # 1, 2 & 3 at Unit-I.	14.10.2026

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC portal only. For further details, please visit websites: www.tnpl.com / <https://intenders.gov.in/nicgep/app> DIPP / **2983** / Tender / 2026

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PUBLIC NOTICE

This notice is issued on behalf of my client **SRI.A.SUDHAKAR** to bring to the notice of the general public that the registered Rectification deed dated 07.01.2016 Doc. No.3451/2015-16 of Book-I, CD No.JAYD242 with respect to Site No.149 situated at J.R.Nagar 9th Phase, EWS Sector, Bengaluru, in the layout formed by the Bangalore Development Authority, Bangalore, measuring East to West:20.0 ft, and North to South:30.06 ft., has been lost at the time of travelling.

All the persons are hereby informed not to deal or carry out any transaction with anyone on the basis of the said. Documents, if anyone has already carried out or being carried out kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 7 days from this present along with that Police Complaint is also given vide Lost Report No.245565/2026 dated. 30.09.2026.

Y. Sowmya Yadav, Advocate
Samvudhithi Legal, # 83, Ground Floor, 5th A' Cross, 21st Main, J.P. Nagar 2nd Phase, Bangalore-78. M : 9916343921

PUBLIC NOTICE

This notice is issued on behalf of my clients **SRI.MURUGAJAN AND SMT.RASHMI** to bring to the notice of the general public that the Original Sale deed dt.17.07.1998 / 11.06.1997 registered as document No.3213/1997-98 of Book-I, Volume-1753 at Pages 241-245 and registered in the office of the Sub-Registrar Kengeri, Bangalore in respect of Site No.5, Khatha No.24513, measuring East to West 70'x72.52 feet and North to South 45 feet, total measuring 3286 Sq.ft. Situated at Halseygarhalli Village, Kengeri Hobli, Bangalore South Taluk, Bangalore has been lost at the time of Travelling.

All the persons are hereby informed not to deal or carry out any transaction with anyone on the basis of the said Sale deed. If anyone has already carried out or being carried out kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 7 days from this present along with that Police Complaint is also given vide Lost Report No.2455146/2026 dated. 30.09.2026.

Y. Sowmya Yadav, Advocate
Samvudhithi Legal, # 83, Ground Floor, 5th A' Cross, 21st Main, J.P. Nagar 2nd Phase, Bangalore-78. M : 9916343921

ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Project office, Rayapudi (V), Thullur (M), Amaravati-522237, A.P.

E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
NIT No.38/MAU61-USIOBH(OTH)/206/2026-CEAG -part (1) Dt. 30.09.2026

Name of Work: APCRDA-Housing & Buildings -District Cooling Plant for R2P for "Development of District Cooling System for Business Entities along Seed Access Road in Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh under Public Private Partnership (PPP) Basis". The bid can be deposited on AP e-procurement portal from **06.10.2026 up to 16.10.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.** Due date for submission of Bid **20.11.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs.** Technical bid opening **20.11.2026 at 16.00Hrs.** For further details please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and <https://crda.ap.gov.in>

Sd/- COMMISSIONER, APCRDA, AMARAVATI

PUBLIC NOTICE

Original Sale Deed dated 15.12.2001 registered as Document No. 1264/ 2004-05 before SRO, Indiranagar, Bengaluru, relating to Flat No. G-1, EDEN AU LAC Apartment, Old Madras Road, New Binnamangala, Indiranagar 1st Stage, Bengaluru-560038, measuring about 2080 Sq. Ft. with proportionate undivided share in land, standing in the names of Sri Guduru Dasaratha Rami Reddy (G.D.R., Reddy) and Smt. Guduru Nirmala Devi, has been lost.

Any person found & having any claim, right, title, interest, lien, charge, mortgage or encumbrance over the said property shall notify the undersigned within 15 days from publication.

JAGADEESH ALURU, Advocate
Indiranagar, Bengaluru Mob: 9845237799

idco ODISHA
150 9081 & 14081 Corporation
NEW OPPORTUNITIES

File No. HO/P&C/EST/IE-3051/01/2026 28487 Dt.25.09.2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (P&C), IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR
Bid Identification No.P&C/EST/IE-29/2026-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

Name of the Work : "Construction of 3 no.s BT road at EMC Park, Info valley-II, Bhubaneswar, Khordha"

1. Value of the Work : Rs.423.85 Lakhs (Approx.)
2. Period of completion : 04 (Four) Calendar Months

Other Details :

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender On-Line for Bidding
Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCO, IDCO Towers, Bhubaneswar-751022	Bid ID No.- P&C/EST/ E-29/2026-27	17:00 Hours of dt. 30.09.2026 17:00 Hours of dt. 14.10.2026

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in **IDCO website.**

Sd/- Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/339/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0122

VISVESVARAYA JALA NIGAM LIMITED
(A Govt of Karnataka Enterprise)
Office of the Executive Engineer VJNL. U.B.P Division
No.2, B.R.Project-577 115

No: V.J.N.L/UBP/E.E.D.2-BRP/TND/2026/27/847 Dated: 25.09.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION
SINGLE COVER SYSTEM (THROUGH KPP Portal ONLY)

On behalf of the Managing Director, Visvesvaraya Jala Nigam Limited, Bangalore, the Executive Engineer, VJNL, UBP Division No.2, B R Project, Shimoga District, Karnataka invites 01 No. of 4701 work with indent numbers VJNL/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT523 for Rs. 35.28 Lakhs through KPP Portal on "Percentage basis" from eligible enrolled Government KPWD Class-III registered under Shivamogga circle and above Contractors. The contractor can access tender documents from 29.09.2026 onwards in KPP Portal website. The details of EMD, Tender Processing fee, Calendar of events, contractor class, tender rules and regulations and other details can be obtained from <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> or from the under signed in the office hours. Last date of submission of tender is on 07.10.2026 upto 17.30 hrs. Any corrigendum or Addendum will be published in KPP Portal website.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer, VJNL, UBP Division
No.2, B.R.Project-577115.

DIPP/SMG/No-147-09/zenkar/2026-27

PUBLIC NOTICE

Our Client has entered into an Agreement of Sale with (1) Mr.RAJA RAMAKRISHNA, Aged about 67 years, S/o. S. Ramakrishna, (2) Mrs. PRAMEELA RAJA, aged about 63 years, W/o. Raja Ramakrishna and (3) Ms. RAADHIKA RAJA, D/o. Raja Ramakrishna, all residing at Flat 101, Elegant Labh 35, Cline Road, Ambekdar Dental College, Cooke Town, Frasier Town, Bangalore - 560005, for the purchase of the under-mentioned Schedule Property.

Any person's financial Institution/s, predecessors-in-title or their legal heirs having any legitimate claim, right, title or interest over the Schedule property or any part thereof in any manner or against the owner/s of the schedule property or objecting to the sale in favour of my client should contact the undersigned in writing within **10 days** (Ten Days) of the issuance of this Public Notice with all documentary proof on which they are basing and asserting their rights, after which period any claim or objection will not be binding over the schedule property.

SCHEDULE PROPERTY

A Three Bedroom Apartment bearing Unit A 101 in the First Floor in the residential apartment building known as "ELEGANT LABH MANSION" having super built-up area of 2516.93 Square Feet which is inclusive of proportionate share of common areas, with TWO covered car parking space No.A 101 in the still/beamage floor, bearing Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike Khatha No. 35/3, PID No. 86-28-35/3, presently within Ward No. 59 - Maruthivevanagar, Bangalore North City Corporation New EPID No. 5345439693, situated at Cline Road, Near Ambekdar Dental College, Cooke Town, Bangalore - 560005, alongwith an undivided 10.30% or i.e. 661.05 Sq. Ft. share in the land comprised in the Property bearing Corporation No. 35 (Old No.1), situated in Cline Road, Cooke Town, Ward No. 86, Unique P.I.D. No. 86-28-35, Bangalore.

Sri. Vinay Paul T.K.,
Advocate, 'U & V Legal', Chambers: FF2, 'Gokul Towers', # 86, M.S.R. Road, Gokula, Bengaluru - 560 054. Cell. 9448058394, E-mail: vinaypaultk@gmail.com

Date:30.09.2026
Place: Bangalore

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PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I Mohamed Osman S/O, Abdul Aziz Sab R/o H No E/8/3/50 Qureshi Mohaleha Shorapur 585224 have changed my name to Mohamed Usman Sab.

I, **YASHASWINI M. D/o Manjunatha N. R/o No.01, Rajarajeshwari Nagar, Hunasamaranahalli, Hosahalli, Bangalore-562157** have changed my name to Yashaswini M vide affidavit dt:29.09.2026 sworn before Notary A.R.Muneer Ahmed, B'lore

I, **D Aruna** is wife of No 10490233L Rank NK Name Lashimanan M presently residing at Vill-Malamanjanoor, PO- M Pudur, Teh-Chengam, Dist-Thiruvannamalai, State-Tamil Nadu have declared to changed my name from D Aruna to L Aruna vide affidavit dt: 30.09.2026 sworn before Notary S.I.Balaguru, B'lore.

I, **No 10490233L Rank NK Name Lashimanan M** presently residing at Vill-Malamanjanoor, PO- M Pudur, Teh-Chengam, Dist-Thiruvannamalai, State-Tamil Nadu have declared to changed my name from Reshi L vide affidavit dt: 30.09.2026 sworn before Notary S.I.Balaguru, B'lore.

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites Tenders from registered Agencies for the following Works.

Office of the Chief Engineer (Central), 6th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560009.

Sl. No.	Division	IFT Number	Sl. No.	Amount Put to tender EMD Amount	Last Date & Time for Submission of Tender	Date & Time for Opening of Tender
1	(Central-2)	BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026	1	Rs. 10,96,940/- Rs. 27,425/-	15-10-2026 Upto 5.00 PM	16-10-2026 After 5.30 PM
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026	2	Rs. 23,07,148/- Rs. 50,000/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026	3	Rs. 48,43,091/- Rs. 96,900/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026	4	Rs. 88,43,330/- Rs. 1,76,890/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026	5	Rs. 94,06,859/- Rs. 1,88,150/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026 (Reserved for SC Category)	6	Rs. 38,18,836/- Rs. 38,190/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026 (Reserved for ST Category)	7	Rs. 41,80,573/- Rs. 41,810/-		
		BWSSB/EE(Central)-2/PB/1123/2026-27 Dated: 25-09-2026 (Reserved for CAT-IIA)	8	Rs. 34,49,511/- Rs. 34,495/-		

Sd/- Executive Engineer (Central-2)

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement Portal process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. For further details contact the above signed office during working hours. DIPP/CPAdvtto301/2026-27

RAICHUR POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
(A JOINT VENTURE COMPANY OF KPCL - BHEL)
(YERMARUS THERMAL POWER PLANT)
CIN : U40101KA2009PLC049582

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through e-Procurement Portal)

RPCL Invites bids from reputed bidders under "WORKS" category through KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> for the following works.

1) KPCL/2026-27/GH/WORK_INDENT4840 Dated: 25.09.2026. Revamping of different capacity 58 Nos of electric hoists in CHP area at YTPS. Last Date & Time for bid submission along with Technical & Financial bid (Part I & II) is on 25-10-2026 up to 11.00 hrs. Any further details can be obtained from the Executive Engineer (CHPE), RPCL, Yermarus Thermal Power Station, Yermarus 584134, Dist. Cell: +91-9448679470. E-mail: eechpeytps@gmail.com.

2) KPCL/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT4841 Dated: 25.09.2026. Erection of HT Junction Box and Single Core Copper Power Cable termination works for RWP Motors at Jackwell. Last Date & Time for bid submission along with Technical & Financial bid (Part I & II) is on 06-10-2026 up to 17.00 hrs. Any further details can be obtained from the Executive Engineer (OLA), RPCL, Yermarus Thermal Power Station, Yermarus 584134, Dist. Tele/Fax: 08532-286003. Cell: +91-9480682501. E-mail: eee4ytps@gmail.com.

3) KPCL/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT4483/CALL-3 Dated: 28.09.2026. Repair/Rectification of 3.3KV, 1450KW, CEP-2B motor at YTPS. Amount Put to Tender: Rs.39,28705/-. EMD: Rs.76,600/-. Last Date of Receipt of Tender is on 05-10-2026 up to 16.00 hrs. Contract Period : 3 months from the date of issue of clearance / work front. Any further details can be obtained from the Executive Engineer (HT/LT/PS), RPCL, Yermarus

B.R. Patil writes to Rahul Gandhi seeking intervention to safeguard agricultural lands

The legislator said the Congress had promised in its 2023 Assembly polls manifesto to repeal ‘anti-farmer laws’ introduced during the BJP regime

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Senior Congress legislator B.R. Patil has written to Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi seeking his intervention “to restore adequate safeguards governing the purchase and holding of agricultural lands.” This comes days after Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, responding to a question raised by Mr. Patil in the Assembly, said there was “no proposal before the government to reinstate sections 79-A, 79-B, and 79-C of Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961.”

Devaraj Urs’s legacy
These sections, introduced in 1974 as part of the land



Three sections, introduced in 1974 as part of land reforms during Devaraj Urs’s tenure, barred non-agriculturalists from buying agricultural land in the State, and were repealed by the BJP in 2021.

reforms during D. Devaraj Urs’s tenure, barred non-agriculturalists from buying agriculture land in the State and were repealed by the previous BJP regime in 2021, then opposed by the Congress.

The Congress had also promised to repeal “anti-farmer laws” introduced during the BJP regime - referring to amendments to the Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961, and Karnataka Agricultural Produce

Marketing (Regulation and Development) Act, 1966 - in its manifesto ahead of the 2023 Assembly polls, as pointed out by Mr. Patil in his letter.

Data presented by the Chief Minister in response to Mr. Patil’s question in the Assembly shows 19.97 lakh acres of agricultural land was sold since sections 79-A, 79-B, and 79-C were repealed in 2021.

“These figures warrant your immediate intervention and also call for an imminent need for a policy change at the State level. The issue is no longer confined to individual transactions in agricultural land; it concerns the continuing reduction of land available for cultivation, the position of small and marginal

farmers, the rural economy and the State’s long-term food security,” he said in his letter to Mr. Gandhi.

He appealed for a policy review within the party that the “State government be called upon to undertake, without further delay, a comprehensive review of the amendments made to the Karnataka Land Reforms Act.” He said the State government should take a clear policy decision, and announce a clear roadmap for restoring appropriate safeguards.

Farmers’ demand
Badagalpura Nagendra, farmer leader with Samyukta Horata-Karnataka, a coalition of farmers, stu-

dents, workers and Dalit groups, said as Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president, Mr. Shivakumar assured them and even signed a petition to reinstate sections 79-A, 79-B, and 79-C of Karnataka Land Reforms Act, 1961 at a farmers’ meeting in Gandhi Bhavan ahead of the 2023 Assembly polls and said the “volteface was unfortunate.”

He warned the State government of launching a State-wide agitation seeking reinstatement of these safeguards if the Congress does not fulfill its manifesto promise to the farmers.

Asked about Mr. Patil’s letter, Mr. Shivakumar said the matter would be examined.

2% cinema ticket cess: State assures HC of no coercive action against petitioners for now



The petitions were filed by Multiplex Association of India, PVR INOX, and Vinayaka Chitramandira Theatre. FILE PHOTO

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The High Court of Karnataka on Wednesday recorded the State government’s assurance that no coercive action would be taken against cinema theatre/multiplex operators, who have challenged the constitutional validity of the newly introduced 2% cess on movie tickets under the Karnataka Cine and Cultural Activists (Welfare) Act, 2024.

Justice H.T. Narendra Prasad, hearing petitions filed by Multiplex Association of India, PVR INOX, and Vinayaka Chitramandira Theatre, noted the submission made by the government advocate that no coercive steps would be initiated against the petitioners for violation of the provisions of the Act until the next hearing.

No interim order
Following this assurance from the government, the court did not pass any interim order, including staying of the operation of the Act, which came into force on September 30. The protection from coercive action would be available only to the petitioners.

The petitions challenge Sections 9(1), 9(2), cine and cultural activists welfare cess, and Section 11, which mandates every employer to deposit the cess by the 10th of every month and submit prescribed half-yearly online returns with all required information of the Act.

Besides, the petitioners also challenged Rule 8(1) of the Karnataka Cine and Cultural Activists Social Security and Welfare Rules, 2025, which specifies cess as 2% of cinema ticket price. Challenging the levy, the petitioners argued that the State lacks legislative competence to impose cess.

‘No direct nexus’
They further submitted that the cess lacks a direct nexus with the beneficiaries of the welfare fund as the fund is intended to support several organisations operating beyond the sphere of cinema, despite the levy being imposed exclusively on cinema tickets. The High Court adjourned further hearing on the petitions till October 26, while directing the government to file its written response to the petitions.

Changes in PF withdrawal rules draw ire of garment workers

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Garment workers of Karnataka have become restive over changes brought to Provident Fund (PF) withdrawal, which came into effect from July 1, 2026. The change allows partial withdrawal of upto 75%, while the remaining amount will remain in the PF account, a move that has been opposed by workers. Protests have erupted in several places already.

On Wednesday, protesting garment workers from three garment companies in Peenya, including president of Garment and Textile Workers Union R. Prathibha, were taken into preventive custody after police resorted to mild



The change allows partial withdrawal of upto 75%, while the remaining amount will remain in the PF account, a move that has been opposed by the workers. FILE PHOTO

lathicharge to stop them from obstructing traffic. A senior police official said that the Peenya police have registered multiple FIRs against over 60 workers under sections of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for “obstruction of duty of the police

personnel, rioting, unlawful assembly, wrongful restraint, and damaging public property.” Garment workers protested in Maddur, Shikaripura, Haveri, Tumakuru, and Tiptur, besides Peenya and Bommasandra in Bengaluru recently. Meanwhile, with the protest threatening to grow bigger, Labour Minister Santhosh Lad has convened a meeting with all stakeholders on Thursday.

As per the rules, to withdraw the remaining 25% of PF, workers will be forced to remain unemployed for a mandatory period of 12 months, which is a change from the past where the workers were allowed to withdraw 100% of their PF accumulation within two months after leaving employment, GATWU general secretary K.R. Jayaram said. “If workers secure employment within 12 months, the 25% will continue to be in the account. Even for 75% withdrawal,

workers have to provide reasons for the need that may include education, marriage, or housing. Workers, in many case, utilise this fund to seek housing space on lease as rents in Bengaluru is prohibitive, since workers receive meagre salary,” he argued.

As workers were affected by the new changes, GATWU held meetings with provident fund officials to whom a memorandum signed by about 5,000 garment workers has been handed over.

Pension scheme
Another major issue flagged by GATWU pertains to the change in the pension fund, which has riled the workers. “Earlier,

workers could access fund in the Employees’ Pension Scheme fund immediately even though their employment was less than 10 years. The full EPS accumulation was given within two months. However, workers will have to wait for 36 months before they can access this fund now,” Mr. Jayaram said.

All India Central Council of Trade Unions State secretary Maitreyi K. said: “No action should be taken against garment workers. We believe that the specific issue with garment workers is low wages with no savings and extreme dependence on PF.”

The All India Trade Union Congress also condemned the police action against the workers.

New Textile and Apparel Policy announced

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The State government announced a new Textile and Apparel Policy 2026-2031, with an aim to secure ₹20,000 crore in domestic and foreign direct investment across Karnataka’s textile value chain over the next five years. The policy also aims to create 5 lakh new jobs in the sector, with a focus on Kalyana Karnataka and tier-2/3 cities.

The policy was introduced in accordance with the 100-day campaign programmes of the Chief Minister and was approved by the Cabinet. According to the government, special emphasis has been put on 34 taluks to promote new investments and generate jobs. Units in these taluks are eligible for additional incentives under the policy. Activities related to silk yarn production have been brought within the scope of the policy.

IAT recommends pension or life insurance cover to insulate farmers from distress

B.S. Satish Kumar
BENGALURU

The Institution of Agricultural Technologists (IAT) has recommended to Karnataka government to consider introducing Farmers’ Pension Scheme or Farmers’ Life Insurance Scheme among other measures to support farmers as well as agricultural sector during distress like drought.

The IAT, which is a policy advocacy body with 6,000 agricultural experts as its members, has recommended both immediate- and long-term measures to be taken to mitigate the impact of drought. In the recommendations submitted to Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, IAT president A.B. Patil pointed out that of the nearly 79 lakh small and marginal farmers in the State, about 20% were above the age of 65 and could be considered for pension. “Otherwise, the farmers’ life insurance could be considered in line



The IAT, which is a policy advocacy body, has recommended long- and immediate-term measures to mitigate the impact of drought.

with crop insurance,” he said.

He said the present drought should be treated not merely from the temporary relief perspective, but seen as an opportunity to transform Karnataka’s agricultural policy’s approach from drought response to drought resilience.

The IAT has suggested that the government should establish a dedicated Karnataka Drought Resilience Mission integrating the Departments of Agri-

culture, Horticulture, Watershed Development, Animal Husbandry, Rural Development and Water Resources, Karnataka State Natural Disaster Monitoring Committee, IMD, State Agricultural Universities, and professional institutions.

Crop loss assessment
As an immediate measure, IAT suggested recording village-wise crop losses, and providing compensation to eligible farmers at the earliest. The crop loss

assessment and compensation payment process could be expedited based on geo-referenced, satellite-supported, Farmer Registration and Unified beneficiary Information System (FRUITS) data, and ground-truthed assessment, it said. It has also suggested quick settlement of crop insurance claims through a special campaign, involving remote sensing.

Stressing the need to focus on water security, IAT suggested mandatory water budgeting at the gram panchayat-level in drought-prone areas and activities like building bunds, farm ponds, check dams, recharge pits under VBG-RAM G scheme. At the larger level, it has suggested tank rejuvenation programmes.

Laying emphasis on watershed development for drought-proofing, it has suggested launching of “One Taluk-One Drought Resilience Plan” based on watershed principles.

100 start-ups to get govt. departments as first customer

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka’s ‘Government First’ initiative is being implemented to provide start-ups with opportunities to develop solutions for the requirements of government departments, test and evaluate their products and technologies in

real government environments, and enable successful solutions to be considered for government procurement, said Priyank Kharge, Minister for Home, Information Technology, Biotechnology, and e-Governance, here on Wednesday.

The initiative, being implemented as part of the

Elevate programme under the Karnataka Startup Policy 2025-30, has been approved by the State government. It aims to support up to 100 start-ups over a three-year period, with a total allocation of ₹25 crore.

According to the Minister, the key objective of the initiative is to create early

market opportunities for start-ups developing new technologies and innovative solutions. Rather than functioning merely as a buyer, the government is establishing a system where it can become the first customer to adopt innovative solutions and a partner in fostering innovation, he said in a release.

The initiative covers a range of services and technology-based solutions, including information technology, AI, data analytics, consultancy services, design, and transportation systems.

Eligible start-ups will receive support of up to ₹25 lakh each for pilot deployment and evaluation.



ಶ್ರೀರಾಂಪುರ ಪಟ್ಟಣ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಲಯ
ಮೈಸೂರು ಜಿಲ್ಲೆ - 570026 , ದೂ: 0821-2330109. ಇ-ಮೇಲ್: ka.srirampur.tp@gmail.com
ಸಂ: ಶ್ರೀ.ಪ.ಪಂ.ಕಾ.ಜೆ.ಇ./ಸಿಂ.ಪಂ.05/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ: 28.09.2026

ಬೆಂಚರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ (ಕೆ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ. ಸೋರ್ಸರ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಮಾತ್ರ)

ಶ್ರೀರಾಂಪುರ ಪಟ್ಟಣ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿ ಮುಖ್ಯಾಧಿಕಾರಿವರು, ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಸಾರ್ವಜನಿಕ ಸಂಗ್ರಹಣೆಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಪಾರದರ್ಶಕತೆ ಅದ್ವಾದೇಶ 1999-2000 ಪ್ರಕಾರ ಕೆ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ. ಮೈಸೂರು ಮಂತ್ ಪ್ರೋಟೋ ಮುಖಾಂತರ 2026-27ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿ ನಿಧಿಯಡಿ ಕೆಳಗಿನ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಗೆ ಅರ್ಹ ನೋಂದಾಯಿತ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರಾದ ಬೆಂಚರ್‌ಗಳನ್ನು ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದೆ. ಇ-ಮೇಲ್‌ಪುಟ <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ಮೂಲಕ ಇವುಗಳನ್ನು ಪರಿಶೀಲಿಸುವುದು. ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ವಿವರಗಳನ್ನು ಕಛೇರಿ ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್ <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ನಿಂದ ಪಡೆದುಕೊಳ್ಳಬಹುದು.

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ಕ್ರ. ಸಂ.	ವಿವರ	ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ (ರೂ. ಲಕ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ)	ಇ.ಎಂ.ಡಿ ಮೊತ್ತ (ರೂ. ಲಕ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ)	ಮೀಸಲಾತಿ
01	DMA/2026-27/BD/WORK_INDENT62640	99.96	1.69	Others

ಸೂಚನೆ: ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ವಿವರ ಹಾಗೂ ಮಾಹಿತಿಗಳನ್ನು <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ಪ್ರೋಟೋಸಲ್ಲಿ ನೋಡಿಕೊಳ್ಳುವುದು.

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ಪಟ್ಟಣ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿ, ಶ್ರೀರಾಂಪುರ DIPR/MYS/792/SA/2026-27 ಪಟ್ಟಣ ಪಂಚಾಯಿತಿ, ಶ್ರೀರಾಂಪುರ

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

In Loving Memory of



MR. RAMABHADRAN SESHADRI (RAMJEE)
29 September 2026

With deep sorrow, we announce the peaceful passing of Mr. Ramabhadran Seshadri (Ramjee) at his residence on 29 September 2026. Rising from humble beginnings to senior corporate leadership, he was admired for his integrity, positivity, and lifelong curiosity. A devoted son, loving father, joyful grandfather, and a constant companion to his wife of over sixty years, Vatsala, he lived a life of service, compassion, and unwavering dedication to family and community.

Rituals at the family residence on 1st October at 7:30 AM, followed by final rites at Banashankari Crematorium between 10:00 AM and 11:00 AM.

Vatsala, Apsara, Aparna, Anand, Jay, Jayanth, Jayasree & Grandchildren Sadhana, Bhavana, Vedh, Neel & Abhay

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

Forty-Second Anniversary
Our respectful Homage to



Shri. A.K. SAMBASIVAN F.C.A.
22.08.1905 to 01.10.1984
Partners & Staff of **R.G.N.PRICE & Co.,**
Members of the Family

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DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

Civic body adopts resolution declaring Belagavi as integral part of Karnataka

The resolution was passed amid objections from members of the Maharashtra Ekikaran Samiti

The Hindu Bureau
HUBBALLI

The Belagavi City Corporation (BCC) on Wednesday adopted a resolution declaring that Belagavi is an integral part of Karnataka, following directions from the State government. The resolution was passed without discussion amid objections from members of the Maharashtra Ekikaran Samiti (MES).

The resolution, a long-standing demand of Kan-nada organisations, was taken up during the evening session as it figured at the end of the agenda of the general council meeting.

Before the matter was considered, BCC Commissioner Kartik M. informed the house about a commu-



Belagavi City Corporation councillors during the general council meeting on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

nication received from the Urban Development Department in response to the corporation's query on the issue.

Referring to a government letter dated August 29, he said the State government had directed the corporation to proceed in accordance with a resolution adopted by the Karnataka Legislative Assembly on March 23, 1988.

The government had also enclosed the Assembly proceedings, which recorded that the house had unanimously passed resolutions on two occasions seeking full implementation of the Mahajan Commission award and urging the Union government to implement the report without delay, he said.

Following the Commissioner's statement, Mayor

Preeti Kamakar declared that the resolution had been adopted in accordance with the State government's directions. The text of the resolution was not read out before its adoption.

MES member Ravi Salkunhe objected to the move, arguing that the corporation should not take up the issue while the Karnataka-Maharashtra border dispute was pending before the Supreme Court.

Responding to the objection, Ms. Kamakar said the corporation was acting on the directions issued by the State government. The meeting concluded with the National Anthem immediately after the Mayor's announcement, leaving no opportunity for members to debate the resolution.

Cong. takes out Bharat Jodo 2.0 in Shikaripur

The Hindu Bureau
SHIKARIPUR (SHIVAMOGGA)

The Congress in Karnataka launched a series of marches titled Bharat Jodo 2.0 in Shikaripur on Wednesday. The constituency was long represented by former Chief Minister B.S. Yediyurappa and is now represented by BJP State president B.Y. Vijayendra.

Hundreds of Congress workers took part in the march, which began at Kittadahalli, about 10 km from Shikaripur town. The march began around 11 a.m., after the National Song, *Vande Mataram*, and the national anthem were rendered, in the presence of KPCC president B.K. Hariprasad, Minister Yathindra Siddaramaiah, N. Basavanthappa, and other party leaders.

Addressing the gathering at Kittadahalli, Mr. Hariprasad said that four years ago on this day, the Bharat Jodo Yatra, led by AICC leader Rahul Gandhi,

had entered Gundlupet. In memory of the historic yatra, which covered the distance from Kanyakumari to Kashmir, the Congress in Karnataka had launched Bharat Jodo 2.0.

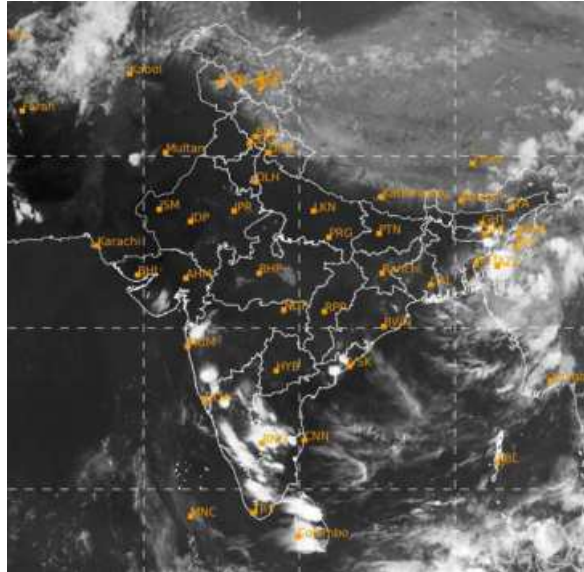
"The yatra is to spread awareness about the discrepancies in the SIR of electoral rolls by the Election Commission, through which 1.5 crore voters are being kept out of the electoral roll," he said.

Party workers and leaders walked along the route connecting Kittadahalli to Shikaripur via Mattikote Cross, Hosanagara, and Nelavagavilu. Many wore caps to protect themselves from the scorching sun, and the organisers had arranged drinking water along the route.

The march disrupted the movement of public transport and private vehicles, and many buses were seen taking alternative routes as the road was occupied by party workers.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Thursday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Rayalaseema

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		33.6	26.0	Kurnool		37.9	25.6
Ahmedabad		34.8	22.6	Lucknow		32.2	23.2
Aizawl		31.5	23.2	Madurai		38.4	27.1
Bengaluru		30.1	19.8	Mangaluru		32.0	24.8
Bhopal		33.7	19.7	Mumbai		31	32.5
Bhubaneswar		34.5	25.5	Mysuru		33.2	21.0
Chandigarh		33.6	21.0	New Delhi		34.2	22.4
Chennai		37.2	28.9	Patna		32.0	26.2
Coimbatore		33.6	21.0	Port Blair		31.5	25.5
Dehradun		32.0	19.8	Prayagraj		33.4	24.0
Gangtok		25.5	16.9	Puducherry		34.6	27.8
Goa		32.0	25.8	Pune		8.6	30.6
Guwahati		35.4	26.6	Raipur		33.7	24.9
Hubballi		31.0	22.0	Ranchi		29.6	20.0
Hyderabad		34.2	22.6	Shillong		25.8	17.2
Imphal		29.5	22.0	Shimla		26.0	15.8
Jaipur		35.4	24.2	Srinagar		27.9	10.9
Kochi		31.8	26.6	Thiruvananthapuram		34.0	24.9
Kohima		20.8	19.2	Tiruchirappalli		38.3	27.0
Kolkata		34.0	27.8	Vijayawada		35.9	26.2
Kozhikode		35.5	26.5	Visakhapatnam		33.5	27.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	
Ahmedabad		10	27	19		130	106
Bengaluru		15	24		32	119	119
Chennai		7	10	22		115	101
Delhi		10	133	87		113	197
Hyderabad		1	3	17		147	135
Kolkata		9	50	37		192	132
Lucknow		23	32	14		74	73
Mumbai		4	33	49		108	122
Pune		14	66	75		63	131
Visakhapatnam		8	63	17		111	145

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Kidwai treats nearly 600 new childhood cancer cases every year

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The State-run Kidwai Memorial Institute of Oncology (KMIO) treats nearly 600 new childhood cancer cases every year, said institute director R. Krishnappa.

Speaking after inaugurating the Childhood Cancer Awareness Month programme at the institute on Wednesday, Dr. Krishnap-

Around 22,000 new cancer cases are being registered at the institute annually

pa said around 22,000 new cancer cases were being registered at the institute annually.

He said an estimated 975 children are diagnosed with cancer in Karnataka every year, of whom around 280 to 300 are

from Bengaluru. Among cancer cases reported across all age groups, boys account for about 2.7% of cases among males and girls for about 1.3% among females, he said.

Awareness programmes Medical Superintendent T. Naveen said the institute had a dedicated Kapoor Block for the treatment and care of children with cancer.

As part of Childhood Cancer Awareness Month, several awareness programmes would be organised, he said.

The institute also has a bone marrow transplant unit to treat children with challenging cancers such as leukaemia, Dr. Naveen said. "We have the necessary treatment facilities for children with cancer and have adopted modern medical facilities in line

with World Health Organization guidelines to improve survival," he said.

Counselling centre Cancer diagnosis often causes considerable emotional distress among patients and their families, said KMIO Chief Administrative Officer S. Kathyayani Devi.

She said counselling was important to help patients develop the confidence to

face the disease and undergo treatment. The institute plans to submit a proposal to the Department of Women and Child Development for setting up counselling centres for cancer patients undergoing treatment and those who have recovered, she said.

She also stressed the need to conduct cancer-awareness programmes at the district and taluk levels.

INBRIEF



Two A.P. college PG students found dead within five days

Two postgraduate students of Andhra Medical College in Visakhapatnam, one in her final year and the other in her first, have allegedly died by suicide within five days. The police are conducting a detailed inquiry into both deaths.

On September 24, P. Sailaja, a final-year postgraduate student, died at her residence. Her family told the police that career-related stress could have been a factor. On September 28, Y. Sravani, a first-year ENT student, died in her rented accommodation. She had not wanted to continue with the course, according to the police. The two incidents have raised questions about the pressures faced by PG students.

(Those in distress can call: Tele MANAS 14416)

'Dead' for 13 years, accused in narcotics cases held in A.P.

A 56-year-old man, accused in multiple narcotics cases and believed to have died while living under an assumed identity, was arrested by the Kannur City police from Andhra Pradesh after 13 years. The arrested person is K.T. Jose alias Korra Josh Babu, a native of Iritty in Kannur district of Kerala. Accused in drug cases, he reportedly failed to appear before the court in a case in 2008 and was declared a proclaimed offender by the Vadakara NDPS court in 2013.

HC reserves order on plea seeking FIR against Pinarayi

The Kerala High Court on Wednesday reserved its verdict in a petition seeking the registration of an FIR and investigation by the State Police Chief into the predicate offence found during an Enforcement Directorate probe in the CMRL-Exalogic pay-off case. Justice A. Badharudeen observed orally that the question of whether to conduct a preliminary inquiry before registering an FIR would have to be analysed on "a case-to-case basis."

Flying colours



Fire drill: A dog in action during the passing out parade of the 23rd batch of canines and handlers at the 6th Battalion of Andhra Pradesh Special Police at Mangalagiri in Guntur district, on Wednesday. K.V.S. GIRI

Four from Telangana forced to work at Russia warfront: kin

Press Trust of India
HYDERABAD

Four persons from Nizamabad and Kamareddy districts of Telangana were misled by agents and ended up performing military duties at the warfront in Russia, their family members have claimed.

The family members of Bhukya Ravinder, Sirushu Ashok, Megavath Prakash and Mohammed Afzal Khan have submitted a representation at the 'CM Prajavani' (people's grievance redressal programme) here, seeking Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy's immediate intervention for their safe repatriation.

Mandha Bheem Reddy, Vice Chairman of the Te-

langana Government's NRI Advisory Committee, who received the representation, said on Wednesday that it has been forwarded to the top State government officials, who will take up the matter with the Ministry of External Affairs.

The family members said in their representation that the four persons travelled to Russia after being promised employment.

The stranded persons have informed their families that they have crossed into Ukraine. The family members urged Mr. Reddy to coordinate with concerned authorities for verification of their location, release from military-related work and safe repatriation to Telangana.

12 members of U.P. family rescued from alleged bonded labour in Hyderabad

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

A family of migrants workers from Uttar Pradesh, who were allegedly assaulted and prevented from leaving the premises of a construction facility they were working in Telangana, were rescued on Tuesday.

Nearly a year after they arrived in Hyderabad for work, Revenue and Labour officials from Medchal-Malkajgiri district rescued all 12 members of the family from alleged bonded labour conditions at the Candeur constructions facility in Bachupally.

Among those rescued were six children aged between three and 10. During the inspection, officials found four women, aged 40, 25, 20 and 19, and the



Women and children were among the members of the Uttar Pradesh family who were rescued on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

children living in tin-sheet rooms without ventilation. The family cooked and defecated inside these rooms.

Received complaints The rescue followed a complaint by social workers to the Revenue Divisional Officer, Medchal-Malkajgiri district. The migrant work-

Private varsities told to submit audit reports

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Following the Supreme Court order, the Higher Education Department has directed all private universities in the State to submit audit reports, student attendance and other details of the last five years.

The Principal Secretary of Higher Education held a meeting with Vice-Chancellors and registrars of private universities on Wednesday to discuss the same. Some universities submitted the required documents.

However, some have raised objections to the attendance details. "The SC

has sought financial and administrative disclosure, but the State government is even asking for students' attendance data. Some universities have more than 4,000 students. How is it possible to provide attendance data of all the students for the last five years and why is it needed?" questioned a representative of a private university.

Affidavit As per the court's directions, the Chief Secretary of the government has to submit an affidavit before the SC with details collected from each of the private universities.



Good foundation

The festive season looks set to build on months of strong industrial growth

India's industrial growth performance in August continued its strong streak since the beginning of the financial year, and sets the economy up well for the upcoming festive season. Growth in the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) quickened to 8% in August 2026, the second fastest that it has been since at least April 2024, which is the earliest month for which the new series of the IIP has growth data. The fastest growth in this period, of 8.8%, came as recently as June 2026. In fact, IIP growth in the April-August period of this financial year stood at a robust 6.8%, faster than that seen during the corresponding periods of the previous two years. The new series has an updated base year, more data sources, and improved methodology, so this growth performance is as accurate an indication of industrial growth as government data can provide. Moreover, apart from a few divergences, IIP data largely match the trends evident in the Index of Core Industries (ICI), the other government index that measures industrial performance. For example, the IIP shows that the electricity sector's growth quickened to 12.3% in August 2026, while the ICI pegs it at 11.6%. Similarly, the construction goods sector saw growth come in at a relatively strong 6.4%, albeit slower than July's 8%. In keeping with that, the ICI shows that the cement sector grew by a robust 12.5% in August, though this was slightly slower than the 12.7% in July. The older series of both indices often provided contrary indications, so this alignment is welcome.

The IIP for August also lays out some core strengths that seem to be developing in the economy. The manufacturing sector grew by nearly 9% in August, and averaged 7.6% in the April-August 2026 period. Given that it had grown by about 4.2% in the first five months of the previous financial year, this acceleration is good to see, especially since it comes at a time when producers are facing several input-related pressures. At the start of this calendar year, manufacturing growth seemed to have been driven by a growth in exports. The August data show that this is now being supplemented by a recovery in domestic consumption. The growth in consumer durables stood at 11.1% in August. The consumer non-durables sector returned to growth, of a little more than 2%, after having contracted in July. The effect of the Goods and Services Tax rate cuts in September 2025 should have petered out by now, so this boost in durables production likely means that producers are expecting a strong festive season ahead. The third quarter of the financial year will therefore be crucial for the economy, but the groundwork seems to be in place for a relatively good one.

Bitter pills

The Supreme Court did well to intervene in drug pricing by retailers

The Supreme Court has upbraided disparities between the price to retailer (PTR) and the maximum retail price (MPR) of certain drugs, including those used to treat cancers, in some instances up to 1,000%. These drugs are not available over-the-counter, so hospitals often control which brand a patient uses. As a result, pharmaceutical companies compete for the hospitals' business, not patients'. To incentivise a hospital to stock specific drugs, they deliberately specify inflated MRPs while offering the hospital low PTRs, and the hospital can pocket the difference. The practice does not technically amount to a kickback but is one economically, as manufacturers effectively promise hospitals an embedded financial reward to pick specific products, and leave patients to potentially pay more than the medicines' supply price because hospitals have an incentive to sell brands with the largest margins. When private hospitals also force patients to purchase drugs from on-premise pharmacies – as Competition Commission investigations have established – patients are unable to shop around, undermining normal price competition. So, more affordable equivalent drugs are disadvantaged because of their lower revenue generation potential for hospitals. Patients, meanwhile, face severe financial strain – a concern also flagged by drug regulators in Karnataka and Maharashtra – and could, among those with cancers and chronic conditions, reduce adherence to longer treatment regimens.

The practice arises from a gap in the 2013 Drug (Prices Control) Order, which caps the final maximum price of scheduled drugs, but not the markup on hospitals' transactions. Say the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) calculates the market-derived average price of such a drug to be ₹100, making the ceiling ₹116. If a hospital negotiates a PTR of ₹50 from the manufacturer, it can still sell the drug (or bill the government if a drug is state-financed) at ₹116, without breaching the ceiling, and enjoy the difference of ₹66. In a proof-of-concept exercise in 2019, the NPPA capped the trade margins of 42 non-schedule anti-cancer drugs at 30%. The Department of Pharmaceuticals subsequently said prices of 526 brands dropped by up to 91%, suggesting that the MRPs of several cancer drugs included compressible margins. Second, while the Court's suggestion to have a fixed percentage markup across all drugs is appealing, it should accompany a regressive margin that applies a smaller percentage as drug prices increase, to neutralise sellers' incentive to favour more expensive products. Overall, however, the Court is right to highlight this insidious problem, especially after refusing to intervene in *Siddharth Dalmia* (2025), and while the Union and States have failed to counterbalance the absence of natural market mechanisms to rationalise drug prices.

On October 1, 2025, the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) between India and the four European Free Trade Association (EFTA) states – Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland – entered into force. One year on, the more useful question is not how many tariff lines have fallen, but what kind of partnership the agreement is making possible.

The tariff figures are substantial. EFTA states have offered concessions on 92.2% of their tariff lines, covering 99.6% of the value of India's exports to them. India, in turn, is granting concessions on 82.7% of its tariff lines, covering 95.3% of the value of EFTA's exports. Few market-opening exercises between India and a group of developed economies have been this ambitious.

Lasting partnerships, an India focus

Yet, the defining feature of TEPA lies elsewhere. It was the first trade agreement that India signed with a dedicated chapter on investment and job creation. Under it, the EFTA states aim to raise investment in India by \$100 billion over 15 years and to facilitate one million direct jobs. An agreement based on that is designed to build lasting industrial and technological partnerships.

For a country of just under 4,00,000 people, Iceland's contribution to that partnership was never going to be about scale. It is about experience, particularly in three areas where that experience speaks directly to India's priorities.

The first is geothermal energy, specifically a part of it that receives far less attention than power generation: the direct use of low- to medium-temperature heat. In Iceland, geothermal energy heats nearly every home, dries fish, warms greenhouses and keeps entire communities running through Arctic winters without burning fossil fuels. That century of experience in direct use is what the Himalayan geothermal belt of northern India can draw on.

Consider the apple growers of Himachal Pradesh. Many have long been forced to sell their harvest immediately, at the lowest prices of the season, because they lacked the means to store their crops.

That is now changing. At Tapri, in Kinnaur district, a geothermal facility operated by Geotropy, an Indian-Icelandic venture, uses heat drawn from the ground to dry fruit, and this harvest season, it is running round the clock as growers line up to use it.

A geothermal cooling facility at the same site is due to be completed by the end of the year. Farmers there can now process their produce



Benedikt Höskuldsson

The Ambassador of Iceland to India

An ambitious India-Europe partnership can deliver across trade, technology, energy and Arctic stewardship

and time their sales rather than remain price-takers at harvest, drawing on the same direct-use techniques that Iceland has refined over generations. Or consider the high-altitude communities and installations along India's northern frontier, which depend on fuel hauled along supply lines that can close for months. Heat drawn directly from the ground beneath them offers something no convoy can: energy security that does not depend on the road remaining open.

The second area is carbon capture, utilisation and storage. A NITI Aayog study in 2022 estimated that India could capture some 750 million tonnes of carbon dioxide a year by 2050. The scientific foundations are being laid by the Department of Science and Technology, which has steered India's carbon capture, utilisation and storage (CCUS) research for years and, in December 2025, published the country's first dedicated research and development road map for CCUS in support of the 2070 net-zero goal.

The Union Budget followed in February with an outlay of ₹20,000 crore over five years to take these technologies towards scale in power, steel, cement, refining and chemicals, while public sector companies such as the Oil and Natural Gas Corporation, NTPC Limited (formerly National Thermal Power Corporation) and Indian Oil Corporation Limited are taking the work into the field through feasibility studies, pilot projects and subsurface assessments.

This pre-commercial stage is exactly where Iceland's experience is most valuable, on both sides of the equation. On storage, CarbFix has shown that when carbon dioxide is dissolved in water and injected into basalt, more than 95% of it turns to stone within two years; India's Deccan Trap basalts share striking geological similarities with Iceland's volcanic rock.

New frontiers

On utilisation, Iceland was home to the world's first industrial-scale plant to turn captured carbon dioxide into fuel: Carbon Recycling International's George Olah plant at Svartsengi, which began producing methanol in 2011-12. Its technology now operates on a far larger scale abroad, including in projects involving steel-sector emissions. In May, Carbon Iceland signed a memorandum of understanding with JSW Steel and Bharatya to explore a 3,00,000-tonne-a-year e-methanol project in Raigad, Maharashtra, converting steel-plant emissions into fuel using green hydrogen. The opportunity, therefore, lies less in exporting equipment than in sharing knowledge and

Household debt, financing today against tomorrow

Household borrowing is becoming an integral part of everyday consumption. Credit cards, personal loans, consumer durable loans, digital lending and buy-now-pay-later arrangements have expanded the possibilities of bringing future income into the present. The latest evidence points to a significant expansion of household leverage. According to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), as of September 2025, India's household debt stood at 45.5% of its gross domestic product (GDP). In June 2023, the debt had been around 42% of GDP. The household debt had stood at 39.2% in March 2021. While this remains relatively modest compared with several emerging market economies, the composition and pace of household borrowing deserve closer attention.

The household savings transition

The conventional Indian household financial model was built around savings. This model has been undergoing a transformation. Household net financial savings declined sharply from the exceptionally high levels witnessed during the COVID-19 pandemic, though recent data suggest some recovery. According to the government's response in Parliament, household net financial savings increased to around 6% of GDP in 2024-25 from 5.2% in 2023-24. Thus, the story is not one of an across-the-board collapse of household savings. Housing loans traditionally represented a major component of household debt. Such borrowing creates an asset and can therefore be viewed differently from borrowing to finance routine consumption.

The rapid expansion of personal loans, credit-card borrowing and other unsecured loans raises a different set of questions. These loans enable households to smooth consumption when current income is inadequate, but they also bring future income under commitment. This is particularly important in an economy where employment remains highly unequal and income growth is uneven. A salaried household with predictable monthly earnings can service a loan relatively comfortably. A self-employed worker,



M. Suresh Babu

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India's household debt story is more complicated than the headline number suggests

informal-sector employee or casual worker faces a very different risk profile. The RBI has noted that consumption-oriented borrowing remains significant, although its growth has moderated, while borrowing for productive purposes has been increasing. This should be welcomed, but should not obscure the distributional dimension of household indebtedness.

The fundamental question is why households are borrowing. If borrowing increases because incomes are rising and households are investing in houses, education or productive assets, higher indebtedness need not necessarily be a source of concern. But if borrowing is required to finance food, health care, education, housing rents, durable goods or other routine expenditures because current incomes are inadequate, debt becomes a mechanism for postponing rather than resolving the income constraint.

Digital lending platforms, instant personal loans, app-based credit and online consumer finance have substantially reduced the transaction costs associated with borrowing. The boundary between what a household can afford and what it can borrow becomes blurred. At the macroeconomic level, consumption financed through credit can support aggregate demand. At the household level, however, the same process creates future repayment obligations. When households borrow to finance health care, education, housing or old-age needs, debt is effectively substituting for inadequate social protection. In this sense, household debt is not merely an outcome of individual financial choices. It is shaped by the institutional structure of the economy.

The macroeconomic implications

Household debt has implications beyond individual borrowers. In the short run, credit expansion can stimulate consumption and support economic growth. But excessive household leverage can eventually have the opposite effect. As debt-servicing obligations rise, households reduce discretionary expenditure. Consumption becomes increasingly sensitive to

building partnerships through technology licensing, storage assessment, monitoring and verification, and the co-development of projects as India's pilots scale up.

The third area is the ocean. Iceland's economy was built on the sustainable management of North Atlantic fisheries, and with it came deep expertise in seafood quality, cold-chain logistics and value-added processing. Icelandic companies are already exploring how to bring further processing of North Atlantic catch to Indian shores, creating local jobs and transferring technology under the TEPA concessions.

Iceland has also shown that the greatest gains may lie in what is usually thrown away. Where most fishing nations use only 40% to 60% of each fish, Iceland now uses around 90% of every cod landed, turning skin, liver and bones into medical products, oils and feed. India does not need to catch a single additional fish to create new value, jobs and exports. It needs only to look differently at what its fleets already bring ashore.

All of this sits within a wider frame. Nearly six years of working on energy access at the United Nations, along with a seat at the table during the Paris Agreement negotiations, taught this writer that climate and energy policy are, at their core, exercises in patient and practical partnership between nations. That same spirit defines Iceland's and India's engagement in the Arctic. Iceland is a founding member of the Arctic Council; India has been an Observer since 2013 and has taken that role seriously, publishing its Arctic Policy in 2022 and operating the Himadri research station in Svalbard. As one of the eight Arctic States, Iceland offers India a direct and trusted bilateral channel into Arctic governance and research, complementing its multilateral engagement. For Iceland and India, energy, trade and Arctic stewardship are part of the same conversation.

Some Icelandic arithmetic

TEPA is young, but it is already showing what an ambitious, rules-based partnership between Europe and India can deliver in investment, technology and jobs, as well as in energy, fisheries and shared stewardship of a changing Arctic. It is not a rival to the European Union (EU)-India Free Trade Agreement (FTA) but a complement to it: a working model, already in force, of what the next chapter of Europe-India trade can look like. If readers will permit a small piece of Icelandic arithmetic, TEPA and the EU-India FTA are a case of one plus one equalling three. That is not competition but addition – and a rather good addition at that.

interest rates and employment conditions. The macroeconomic transmission mechanism is straightforward: Income stagnation, borrowing to sustain consumption, rising debt service, declining disposable income, weaker consumption, greater dependence on credit.

If this cycle becomes entrenched, credit ceases to be an instrument for productive investment and becomes a mechanism for sustaining consumption in the face of inadequate income growth. There is therefore a potential contradiction between credit-led consumption growth and income-led demand expansion.

The first can generate a temporary acceleration of demand. The second provides a more sustainable foundation. The policy response to rising household debt should not be simply to restrict lending. Credit is an essential component of economic development, and access to formal credit can substantially improve household welfare. The challenge is to distinguish productive credit from distress credit and asset-building borrowing from consumption smoothing under income pressure.

What the central issue is

India's household debt story is therefore more complicated than the headline number suggests. The government has emphasised that India's household leverage remains below that of many emerging-market peers and that household net financial savings have improved. But the central issue is not simply how much households owe. It is why they owe it, to whom they owe it, at what cost, and against what income.

The danger lies in confusing access to credit with improvement in economic welfare. The more unequal and uncertain incomes become, the greater the temptation to finance living standards through borrowing. The question before policymakers is therefore not merely how to regulate household debt, but how to build an economy in which households can live on their incomes rather than against their future incomes.

The views expressed are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

SIR debate, electoral trust

With the top court upholding the validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted in Bihar, and the Election Commission clarifying its position on the exercise and stating that its decisions were taken unanimously, the legal position on the SIR has been substantially settled. It is difficult to understand why the Opposition and some

television channels continue to question the exercise. Voters have exercised their franchise in favour of both the National Democratic Alliance and the Opposition in different elections. Where, then, is the justification for questioning the Chief Election Commissioner when a party loses an election? Earlier, the Electronic Voting Machine was blamed; now the Chief

Election Commissioner is being questioned. It is undeniable that voters consider their sense of security and the quality of leadership when making their electoral choices.

S. Seshadri,
Chennai

Celebrating victory

I write this letter as a former Deputy General Manager (Sports Department), Rashtriya Ispat Nigam

Limited (RINL), Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (VSP). Whenever athletes win medals at major international sporting events, photographers frequently ask them to hold the medal between their teeth and pose. Indian sportspersons have also increasingly followed this international practice. The medal-biting pose is mainly a modern sports photography tradition. It is

sometimes associated with the old image of biting gold to test its authenticity. However, modern Olympic gold medals are not made of solid gold, and there is no sporting rule requiring an athlete to bite a medal. Could India develop its own dignified and distinctive way of celebrating sporting success? For example, Indian medal winners could be encouraged to hold the medal near their heart, raise

it proudly alongside the Indian Tricolour, salute the National Flag, or adopt another respectful pose representing India's cultural identity. There is nothing wrong with following an international photographic tradition, but there can be a change.

J.L.V. Sastry,
Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

In U.P., the Congress needs the SP

As Uttar Pradesh heads toward its next Assembly contest, Congress strategists are dealing with an uncomfortable truth: in the current alliance, the Samajwadi Party (SP) holds the stronger hand. Beyond the optics of ‘INDIA bloc unity’, the arithmetic and organisational depth point the same way: the Congress needs the SP more than the SP needs the Congress.

The first distinction is structural. The SP is not a personality-led outfit that borrows crowds for a season and vanishes when the tide turns. It has a functioning cadre and booth-level workers; Yadav-Muslim social capital built over three decades; a growing share of non-Yadav Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and Dalits; and a district-to-village skeleton that survives bad election cycles. Compare this to the Trinamool Congress or the Aam Aadmi Party which is based on ‘leader-and-supporter’ constructs; they are formidable when the leader is popular but structurally thin once the wave recedes.

The Congress’s State unit suffers from the ailment the SP has cured. It is a supporter-driven shell, dependent on media cycles, occasional Rahul Gandhi yatras, and transient online support, lacking ground infrastructure to convert sentiment into votes on polling day. The SP’s cadre, by contrast, is a durable asset that isn’t going anywhere regardless of who wins in 2027; that permanence is the leverage.

The second argument, arguably more decisive, is vote arithmetic. U.P.’s contest is no longer a fragmented four-cornered



Syed Kamran

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fight; it has hardened into a bipolar contest between the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the SP-led opposition. The Bahujan Samaj Party’s (BSP) vote share has been steadily eroding, and what remains of it, along with residual anti-BJP sentiment scattered across smaller caste-based and regional outfits, has no natural home. It flows toward whichever non-BJP formation has the most chance of winning.

In a bipolar contest, that residual “anyone but the BJP” vote doesn’t split evenly; it consolidates behind the party seen as the real challenger, and in U.P. that is unambiguously the SP, not the Congress. Voters unhappy with the BJP will vote strategically by gravitating to the SP because it has repeatedly shown itself as the only outfit within striking distance of the BJP’s vote share. The Congress, hovering in single digits across most U.P. assembly segments for over a decade, isn’t part of that calculation for the median opposition voter. Its vote-multiplying value is limited, while the SP’s brand pulls in the anti-incumbency vote that decides seats.

The third argument is narrative ownership. The 2027 U.P. election is shaping Akhilesh Yadav as the face of the opposition and the PDA (*Pichda*, Dalit, *Alpsankhyak* (Backward, Dalit, Minority)) as the organising social coalition. This has been Mr. Yadav’s framework since the 2022 defeat, and it has visibly reshaped how backward and Dalit voters outside the traditional SP base view the party. The Congress has no competing narrative in U.P. with similar traction; its national Nyay (justice) framework and Bharat Jodo-adjacent

messaging hasn’t localised into a U.P.-specific story the way the PDA has.

When one partner owns the narrative and the other is borrowing space within it, the question of who ‘steers the wheel’ answers itself. A realistic path for the Congress lies in being a disciplined junior partner that helps consolidate the PDA coalition in seats where it adds value, such as in Brahmin and urban pockets, rather than insisting on parity in seat-sharing. Overreach risks fracturing an already-fragile anti-BJP consolidation.

The bottom line

This does not mean that the Congress brings nothing to the table; a national party’s symbolic weight does have marginal value. But marginal value is not equal leverage in a State as diverse as U.P. The SP has cadre permanence, the bipolar arithmetic that captures residual anti-BJP votes, and narrative ownership through Mr. Yadav and the PDA. In any honest reading, this is an alliance where one partner can survive alone and the other cannot; and that imbalance should shape how the Congress negotiates seats and its place in the coalition.

The Congress’s best bet is to fight this election in alliance with the SP with realistic seat demands rather than inflated ones – concentrating resources on a limited set of seats. A good strike rate on fewer seats does two things: it hands the Congress a stronger hand in seat-sharing talks for 2029, and it gives the party a real bloc of sitting MLAs; the kind of ground presence no amount of central leadership visibility can substitute for.

How to finance rural prosperity

India’s agricultural transformation is one of the greatest achievements of independent India. Over the past six decades, the nation has emerged as one of the world’s largest producers of cereals, milk, fruits, vegetables and fisheries products. This progress was driven by visionary public policy, scientific innovation, irrigation, institutional credit and the enterprise of millions of Indian farmers.

While India’s first agricultural transformation delivered food security, the next must deliver rural prosperity by enabling rural India to capture a larger share of the value created after harvest. Every agricultural commodity passes through a value chain from production to aggregation, storage, logistics, processing, branding and markets. It is along this chain that enterprises emerge, employment expands and prosperity grows. Financing this change requires moving past production credit towards financing the entire agricultural value chain.

Dairy, poultry and fisheries operate through continuous procurement and marketing cycles, generating predictable cash flows, lower inventory risks and regular working-capital turnover. However, seasonal commodities operate under a very different financial reality. Processors need to procure most of their annual raw material requirement within a short harvest window and finance inventory for the remainder of the year. A company investing ₹500 crore in a modern processing facility may require ₹700–₹800 crore simply to procure, store and carry seasonal inventory.



Sanjay Agarwal

Former Secretary, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India

Without appropriately structured working capital, even efficient enterprises struggle to remain commercially viable. While the sugar sector is also seasonal, its growth demonstrates how inventory finance and warehouse-backed lending can overcome seasonal constraints. The difference in sector growth lies not in production potential but in the way the chain is financed.

Need for new mechanisms

For more than five decades, successive reforms including bank nationalisation, rural banks, cooperative institutions and the Kisan credit card expanded production credit. India has successfully built robust institutions for financing agricultural production when national food security was the priority. It must now build robust mechanisms for financing every commercially viable activity that creates value between the farm and the final consumer.

Encouragingly, elements of such a financing ecosystem are already emerging. Banks have introduced products such as warehouse receipt financing, receivables financing, and financing for food processing and agricultural infrastructure, while agri-focused non-banking financial companies have pioneered innovative value-chain models. However, these remain isolated initiatives rather than components of a comprehensive agricultural value chain financing architecture.

The opportunity is substantial. Based on the difference between the GVA (Gross Value Added) of agriculture and allied sectors (₹48.8 lakh crore) and the institutional credit flow (₹20

lakh crore) during 2023-24, indicative estimates suggest that the financing opportunity across India’s agricultural value chains could exceed ₹14 lakh crore.

While only about 10-12% of agricultural produce is processed in India, the corresponding level is estimated at around 35–45% across East, South and Southeast Asia and often exceeds 60% in many developed economies. In these economies, agricultural transformation is supported by financing systems aligned with commodity-specific value chains rather than production alone.

A comprehensive agricultural value chain financing framework should provide a diverse portfolio of financial instruments, including product finance, receivables finance, warehouse receipt finance, risk mitigation solutions and credit enhancement mechanisms. These instruments can finance the flow of goods, services and capital across the value chain, with financing decisions increasingly based on commodity-specific value chains and cash-flow analysis rather than conventional collateral alone. This will enable capital to reach farmers, input suppliers, aggregators, warehouse operators, processors, logistics providers, exporters and retailers, thereby unlocking private investment, creating rural jobs, improving farmer incomes, and accelerating rural industrialisation.

Building a solid agricultural value chain finance architecture can become one of the most consequential reforms for achieving the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

Rise in EV adoption stresses need for ramping up charging infra

Three-wheeler EVs accounted for the States of Assam, Bihar, West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh showing higher figures in EV adoption

DATA POINT

Sachin Swaraj
Pon Vasanth B.A.

India is slowly but steadily transitioning towards Electric Vehicles (EVs), with cars under the “alternative fuels” category overtaking petrol cars for the first time in August 2026, as per the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations’ (FADA).

Though the alternative fuels category included fuel types such as CNG/LPG, the overall growth in the sale of EVs was significant, as reported by *The Hindu*.

However, State-wise data shows that this growth is not uniform with notable variations even among comparable States. **Table 1** shows the share of EVs and hybrid EVs in the total registrations of all types of vehicles since 2022-23. Only the States and Union Territories (UTs) that registered at least 10,000 EVs (including hybrids) are shown in the table. As the data shows, the first five months of 2026-27 have already seen a significant increase with 12.7% (16.5 lakh) of the roughly 1.29 crore vehicles registered in India being EVs or hybrids. Among the major States and UTs, Keralam, Delhi, Karnataka, Odisha, and Telangana are leading with at least 15% of the registered vehicles being EVs or hybrids.

While Keralam, Delhi, and Karnataka were already showing notable increases in the previous years as well, data shows that the near doubling of the share in Telangana was mainly driven by the three-wheeler segment. Three-wheeler EVs also accounted for Assam, Bihar, West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh showing higher figures. The share of EVs and hybrids in new registrations in 2026-27 will drop to well below 5% if three-wheelers are excluded, analysis showed. Tripura and Assam will drop to the lowest of 2.2% and 2.6% if three-wheelers are excluded.

The disparity between the States and UTs in EV adoption is also visible in terms of availability of EV charging infrastructure and the power consumption from EV charging stations.

Chart 1 shows the power consumption from public charging stations, excluding the heavy-duty ones predominantly used by government-operated e-buses, based on the Central Electricity Authority’s report for the financial year 2025-26. Among the 15 States/UTs with highest power consumption shown in the chart, Maharashtra outperformed other States in both the availability of number of charging locations and their usage measured by the power consumed.

While Delhi showed high usage despite relatively fewer number of charging stations, Karnataka was at the other end with highest number of charging locations but relatively lesser usage. All the other States shown in the chart lagged behind by a wide margin when compared with Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Maharashtra. The map shows whether the charging infrastructure available in public places has grown in proportion to the number of EVs registered across India. It measures how many newly registered EVs share charging infrastructure in a public place. For instance, there is one charging location available for every 997 registered EVs in Assam. Karnataka, on the other hand, has a public charging facility for every 144 EVs registered between 2021-22 and 2026-27 (till August) – indicating the need for the charging infrastructure to grow in places that are adopting quickly to EVs.

Although the map does not show the concentration of the charging facilities within each State, analysis showed they are heavily concentrated in and around major urban centres. For instance, Karnataka has public charging facilities in around 6,000 locations, of which about two-thirds are located in and around Bengaluru.

Uneven growth

The data for the analysis were sourced from Vahan portal, Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) and the Central Electricity Authority (CEA). Data on charging stations sourced from BEE is as of late 2025. Sachin Swaraj is interning with The Hindu’s Data team

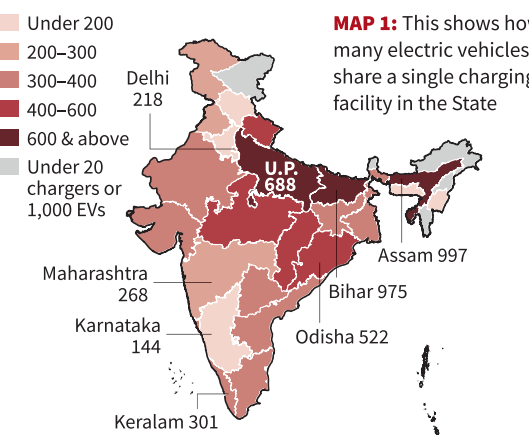
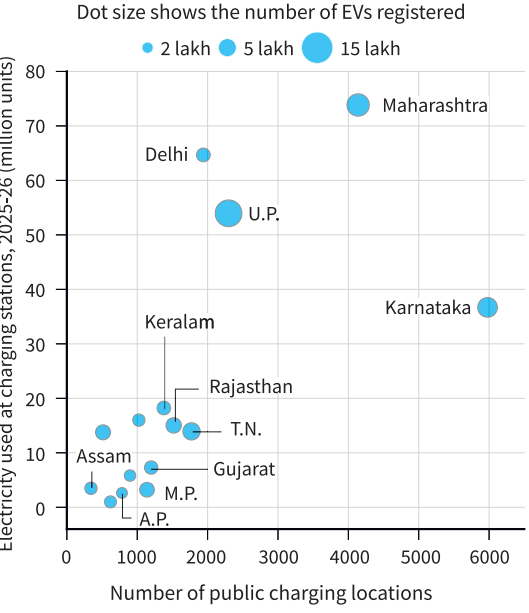


TABLE 1: This shows the share of electric vehicles (EVs) and hybrid EVs in the total number of vehicles registered. Only those States and UTs that registered at least 10,000 EVs and hybrid EVs in 2025-26 are shown

State	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27*
Uttar Pradesh	6.9	9.5	10.9	10.6	12.6
Maharashtra	7.7	9.5	9.6	9.2	13.1
Karnataka	8.6	11.1	11.1	12.7	16.5
Tamil Nadu	5.3	6.7	8.5	9.7	12.9
Madhya Pradesh	3.9	5.8	7.2	9.5	12.6
Keralam	8.7	13.7	14.1	15.5	18.0
West Bengal	2.2	3.4	5.2	10.6	11.6
Bihar	5.8	7.7	8.7	8.6	11.2
Rajasthan	7.4	7.1	7.4	7.6	11.8
Delhi	13.5	15.3	14.7	15.2	17.0
Gujarat	6.1	5.8	4.8	4.9	7.3
Odisha	6.1	7.8	9.3	10.9	18.7
Assam	9.0	10.9	12.4	17.0	20.7
Telangana	4.2	6.3	7.2	8.4	15.1
Andhra Pradesh	4.9	5.1	7.2	7.9	12.4
Punjab	4.6	7.0	8.5	7.7	10.2
Chhattisgarh	6.7	8.5	8.3	8.5	12.7
Haryana	5.8	6.4	6.7	5.7	6.2
Jharkhand	4.3	5.1	5.7	6.4	8.5
Uttarakhand	8.4	8.3	8.8	8.8	11.8
Jammu & Kashmir	4.9	8.5	9.7	8.3	10.3
Goa	12.1	17.0	16.1	14.7	20.1
Tripura	8.8	12.7	16.3	18.4	20.0
All India	6.4	8.1	8.8	9.5	12.7

Share (%) of EV + hybrid in all new vehicle registrations. Lightest shade is <5. Other bands are 5-8%, 8-11%, 11-14%, >14%

CHART 1: This shows the power consumed from public charging stations, when compared with the number of locations in which such infrastructure is available



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 1, 1976

Southern rice zone minus Kerala

New Delhi, September 30: The formation of a southern rice zone, comprising Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Pondicherry, was announced to-day by the Union Minister for Agriculture and Irrigation, Mr. Jagjivan Ram. Kerala will not be in the zone because as Mr. Jagjivan Ram said, “we take the responsibility of supplying the requirements of Kerala from the Central pool.”

Within the zone there would be no curbs on movement of rice.

The northern rice zone will be expanded to include Rajasthan. At present, it consists of Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and Delhi.

Also, there is no change in regard to the kharif cereals other than rice – there will be no restriction on the movement in the country.

Mr. Jagjivan Ram made these points at a press conference, called to announce the kharif policy on the basis of the recommendations of the Agricultural Prices Commission. The Union Cabinet, which considered the Commission’s report this morning, Mr. Jagjivan Ram said, decided to accept its suggestion that the procurement prices of coarse paddy be continued at Rs. 74 per quintal for the coming season. Similarly, the procurement rates of other coarse cereals will remain at Rs. 74 per quintal. The Cabinet, however, decided to reduce the procurement target of rice from 5.5 million tonnes, as recommended by the Commission, to 4.4 million tonnes.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 1, 1926

Poisoning prevented by wireless

London, September 30: The wireless search for Mr. Penn (see message issued yesterday) has ended happily. This afternoon the purchaser of the pills, telegraphed to the Chemist from London where he read of the mistake in a London newspaper, that none of the pills had yet been taken. The pills contained 1/4 grain of Strychnine each, instead of 1/40. The announcement has greatly relieved the chemist, who, upon the discovery of his error, had telegraphed a warning to every Mr. Penn in the directory.

Mamata bats for Rahul as PM, Kharge calls for unity

Prepared to contribute as mere worker with 'no ego', says former Bengal CM; Congress chief says INDIA bloc should first fight threats to democracy; Rahul calls alliance 'defenders of Constitution'

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee endorsed Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi as the face of the Opposition alliance, telling leaders at the INDIA bloc meeting on Wednesday that she would have no objection if Mr. Gandhi were to become the Prime Minister.

Her remarks, however, were promptly met with a note of caution from Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, who said the gathering was not meant to discuss leadership positions but to forge a united response to the challenges facing the country.

Sources said Ms. Banerjee repeatedly emphasised the need for all Opposition parties to work together and said she was prepared to contribute as a mere worker. Stressing that she had “no ego”, she cited her outreach to Biju Janata Dal leader Naveen Patnaik and referred to her recent conversation with CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby, despite the Trinamool Congress and the Left having been longstanding political rivals in West Bengal.



In sync: Sonia Gandhi, Mamata Banerjee, other INDIA bloc leaders address the media in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Pointing towards Mr. Gandhi, Ms. Banerjee said: “If Rahul Gandhi becomes Prime Minister, I have no problem.”

Mr. Kharge intervened soon after, saying the meeting’s purpose was not to decide who would occupy the top post but to stand together to “save the country”.

‘Different atmosphere’
Leaders present at the meeting described the atmosphere as markedly different from the INDIA bloc’s previous gathering on June 8. Wednesday’s discussions were characterised by Congress’s wil-

lingness to accommodate suggestions from all parties.

Ideas mooted by Mr. Baby for a collective representation to the President, by CPI(ML) general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya of taking the agitation on “vote chori” (vote theft) beyond Delhi and the main cities, and by Independent Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal of legally challenging the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Bill, 2023, were accepted.

Rashtriya Janata Dal

leader Tejashwi Yadav suggested that there is a growing need for the INDIA bloc to speak in one voice, for which it should have designated spokespersons.

The bloc agreed that a sub-committee should be formed to take day-to-day decisions.

‘To work with humility’
Mr. Gandhi, who spoke towards the end of the deliberations, stressed the importance of collective action and cooperation among alliance partners. He said the Congress was prepared to work with “humility” alongside other parties and argued that the alliance had a historic responsibility to defend democratic institutions.

“History will remember this group which is sitting here today as the one that defended the Constitution of India,” he said.

Addressing the joint press conference later, Mr. Gandhi returned to the same theme. “Collectively, we are the defenders of the Indian Constitution,” he said, adding that the coming months would be politically significant and that the Opposition intended to intensify its campaign against the government.

CEC has ‘lifelong blanket immunity’ for helping PM Modi ‘steal’ polls: Rahul

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Wednesday alleged that Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar has lifelong immunity from court proceedings because he helped the Narendra Modi government indulge in “vote chori” (theft).

“Q. Why is CEC Gyanesh Kumar the only Indian with lifelong blanket legal immunity? A. Because PM Modi uses him to steal elections,” Mr. Gandhi said on X, shortly after the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance discussed the possibility of challenging the law that gives immunity to the CEC and the other two Election Commissioners.

At the INDIA bloc meeting, former Law Minister Kapil Sibal suggested that the Opposition challenge the 2023 law that gives the CEC and the two Commissioners immunity from criminal and civil proceedings. Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, protects both the CEC and the Commissioners.

A court cannot entertain proceedings against



Mulling a movement: Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi after an INDIA bloc meeting in Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

them for an act done in the discharge of their duty.

While the INDIA bloc is now exploring ways to challenge the law, at Tuesday’s Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting, senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi argued that court appeals often delayed matters. If a legal challenge by the Opposition was not upheld by the higher courts, the issue would not only appear as a setback but also legitimise the law, Mr. Singhvi is said to have argued.

‘Mobilise support’
Several CWC members discussed other ways of building resistance to the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Mr. Singhvi argued that non-political actors could help mobilise public support, and cited the Cockroach Janta Party-led anti-paper leak protests

as an example. He said the protests were effective in mobilising people and had also forced Dharmendra Pradhan to resign as the Education Minister.

However, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and Anand Sharma argued the Congress should take the lead, with other parties and movements joining it.

Another CWC member, Manish Tewari, said the Congress should mobilise every party workers and call them to Delhi to sit on an indefinite dharna, much like what the Punjab farmers did during their opposition to the three farm laws.

Several Congress leaders argued that the party now needed to move beyond courtroom technicalities and work with people who had lost their right to vote, turning the issue into a people’s movement.

EC extends SIR dates for A.P. and Meghalaya

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

A full bench of the Election Commission (EC) convened on Wednesday, in what was the second such meeting in four days, and decided to extend the dates for publication of the final electoral rolls in Andhra Pradesh (A.P.) and Meghalaya, which are among the States where the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is currently under way.

In the EC meeting, attended by Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, it was decided that the final voters’ list of A.P. would be published on October 16 and that of Meghalaya on October 26. The dates had previously been October 3 for A.P. and October 7 for Meghalaya. The claims and objections period in A.P. has been extended until October 10.

According to sources, the Commission also took stock of the implementation of measures announced on September 26, which addressed concerns, including stopping physical hearings for voters who have been flagged under the unmapped or logical discrepancies categories.

Govt. causing an ecological disaster in country: Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Referring to the ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar Island project, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh on Wednesday said the Narendra Modi government was “mindlessly going ahead with inflicting this ecological disaster on our country”.

Reacting to a report in *The Hindu* about the Union government moving the Supreme Court for a stay on hearings in the Calcutta High Court challenging the clearances for the project, the former Environment Minister said he hoped that the top court would let the final hearings continue before the High Court, where petitions have alleged that provisions of the Forest Rights Act, 2006, were violated in obtaining consent for the project.

The Hindu reported on Wednesday that the Union government had filed a petition in the Supreme Court seeking a stay on further proceedings in the matter before the Calcutta High Court.

Mr. Ramesh said the petitions in the High Court represented a “faint glimmer of hope” even as “various approvals under environment and forest laws have been deeply flawed, and the impact assessment reports are of dubious value”.

“The High Court had upheld the right of the petitioner, who has been a very senior official in the Union Ministry of Environment... and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, to file her challenge. Her right to challenge had been questioned by the Modi government, but that had been rejected by the High Court. Now, the government is making the same argument in the Supreme Court, which hopefully will allow the High Court to proceed on the matter as scheduled,” he said.

‘Fragmented’ INDIA bloc is spreading misinformation: BJP

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday hit out at the Congress and its allies, alleging that they were spreading misinformation and undermining democratic institutions. Defending voter-list verification, the BJP also took a jibe at the absence of some alliance partners from the meeting of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance on the special intensive revision (SIR) exercise.

At a press conference, Union Minister and senior BJP leader Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the Congress had failed to introspect despite multiple defeats. “If they win, they hail democracy; if they lose, they condemn the Election Commission. This is their frustration over defeat,” Mr. Chouhan said.

‘Will not improve’
“The Congress has decided that it will not improve. Whether it is Congress president Mallikarjun Khargeji or Rahul Gandhiji, instead of apologising for their mistakes, they are spread-



Shivraj Singh Chouhan

ing confusion. They are lying and making fabricated allegations,” he said.

Referring to the INDIA bloc meeting, he said, “Even before the meeting, the alliance fell apart.” He raised questions over the absence of Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam president M.K. Stalin, and Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal.

Mr. Chouhan alleged that the Opposition alliance had become badly fragmented, with its constituent parties going separate ways. “The truth is that the INDI Alliance is not ready to accept Rahul Gandhi as its leader... even the Congress itself does not have faith in him,” the BJP leader said.

SIR made so many eligible electors lose vote for the first time, says former CEC

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

When Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi found that their objections were not heard, especially regarding the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, they should not have stopped with dissent notes, says former Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) O.P. Rawat. Instead, the two Commissioners should have ensured all decisions taken against their will were annulled at the next meeting of the three-member commission, he said. The third member of the Election Commission is Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Slamming the way the SIR has been carried out, Mr. Rawat noted in an exclusive interview with *The Hindu* on Wednesday that this is the first time since Independence that so many eligible electors had lost their voting rights.

Mr. Sandhu and Mr. Joshi had formally objected to various aspects of the SIR, 14 times over a 10-



O.P. Rawat

month period. Their objections covered several EC decisions, including changes to Form 6, and the ECI-Net portal’s added declaration asking new voters whether they or their parents or grandparents had appeared in the last SIR’s electoral roll.

“They had the majority [in the EC]. In the very next meeting, when their first objections were not heard, they should have annulled all decisions taken against the will of majority. They should have taken the right decision, which would have prevailed. So obviously, but they did not take that route,” he said. Mr. Rawat helmed the poll body be-

ween January 23, 2018 and December 1, 2018. He had been an Election Commissioner from 2015.

‘No veto for CEC’
Describing the EC’s functioning, Mr. Rawat said that commission meetings are usually held regularly. Mr. Rawat said that when the members are not on the same page, meetings help them understand each other’s point of view and bring about an agreement. In the “one in a million” occasion where consensus cannot be reached, he said, there is the recourse of voting, where the majority opinion prevails. “The Chief Election Commissioner himself does not have any veto,” he said.

On the SIR process in West Bengal, he said the damage had already been done before the election. “Ninety-three per cent of deleted voters whose appeals have been decided by tribunals were found eligible, and they missed exercising their voting right. That is something very serious for a democracy,” he said.

Bengal SIR tribunal judge wants to quit over long commute

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

A judge presiding over a special intensive revision (SIR) tribunal in West Bengal has offered to resign, citing the long commute between his residence and his place of work.

Justice Indrajit Chatterjee (retd), formerly judge at the Calcutta High Court, who is presiding over the appellate tribunal in Murshidabad district, has written to the Chief Justice of Calcutta High Court Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge, expressing his wish to discontinue with effect from November 2.

“The government is spending a lot on my vehi-

cle and pilot car. But I have to commute 70 to 80 km from my residence, which takes three to four hours every day. It is difficult to continue under such circumstances,” Justice Chatterjee told *The Hindu*.

He heads the SIR tribunal number 11, Murshidabad district, where the names of about 4.55 lakh electors have been deleted from the electoral rolls due to “logical discrepancies”.

About 27.1 lakh voters were removed from the State’s electoral rolls due to “logical discrepancies” before the Assembly election was held earlier this year. Over 22 lakh voters have filed appeals challenging their exclusion.

ଓଡିଶା ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ଉନ୍ନୟନ ଓ ବିକାଶ ସମିତି
ପଞ୍ଚାୟତିରାଜ ଓ ପାହାଣ୍ଟି ଜନ ବିଭାଗ, ଓଡିଶା ସରକାର

Odisha Rural Development & Marketing Society
creating competence and values in rural Odisha
Panchayati Raj and DW Department, Government of Odisha

NOTICE

Expression of Interest for Empanelment of PIAs under Captive Employment Category "A" for DDU-GKY 2.0 Projects in Odisha State

No.2859 / PT1-ORMAS-SD-DDU-GKY-0007-2025 Date : 30.09.2026

Odisha Rural Development and Marketing Society (ORMAS), under the Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water Department, Government of Odisha, invites proposals from agencies registered with the Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD), Government of India and possessing a valid Permanent Registration Number (PRN), for empanelment and implementation of DDU-GKY 2.0 projects in the State of Odisha under "Captive Employment Category- A".

Interested agencies may submit their proposals through the DDU-GKY online portal of MoRD, Government of India (<https://kaushal.rural.gov.in>), in accordance with the DDU-GKY 2.0 Operational Guidelines, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and other instructions issued by MoRD from time to time.

The last date for submission of proposals is **21st October 2026**. Detailed terms and conditions of the Expression of Interest (EOI) are available on the portal at <https://kaushal.rural.gov.in>

Chief Executive Officer, ORMAS

SIRD Campus, Unit - VIII, Bhubaneswar, Odisha - 751012
Tel# 0674-2565870/71, E-mail : ormasha@gmail.com, URL : www.ormas.org
19001/275/2627 OIPR-19001/19004/1/26-27/0011

Government of Odisha
Information & Public Relations Department
Lok Sampark Bhawan, Bhubaneswar

Request For Proposal (RFP) from the eligible bidders to Conceptualize, Design and Fabricate the Odisha Pavilion at India International Trade Fair (IITF)-2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.

BIDDER'S DATA SHEET

Sl.No.	Particular	Details
01.	Name of the Client	The Director, I&PR Department, Odisha
02.	Method of Selection	Quality and Cost Based Selection (QCBS) Method
03.	Date of the Issue of RFP	30.09.2026
04.	Pre-Bid Consultation with intending bidders	06.10.2026 at 11:30 AM
05.	Venue of Pre-Bid Consultation	Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001
06.	RFP Due Date	14.10.2026 by 05.00 PM
07.	Date & Time of Opening of the Proposal	15.10.2026 at 11:30 AM
08.	Venue of Opening of Proposal	Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001
09.	Address for Submission of Proposal	The Director, I&PR Department, Odisha Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001 (Odisha), Telephone No-2394890, Email: fpiprodisha@gmail.com
10.	Mode of Submission	➤ Speed Post/Registered Post/Courier Service only ➤ Proposals submitted in any other mode and the ones received late will not be taken into consideration

DIRECTOR, I&PR
OIPR-15001/15001/1/26-27/0101

SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LIMITED

e-Procurement Tender Notice (Paper Notification)

TSPDCL intends to float tender for procurement of (a) Desktop Computers (b) 8.1 m/280 kgs PSCC Poles to various circles of TSPDCL. (c) 11 m/385 kgs PSCC Poles to various circles (d) 11 KV 200A (TT) GOAB Switches with Polymer Insulators (e) LT Distribution Boxes (SMC) of TSPDCL on e-procurement platform.

For further details of each item above, please visit www.tgssouthernpower.org, www.tender.telangana.gov.in, www.auction.telangana.gov.in.
Phone : 040-23431360, 1033, 1035, 1026.

R.O. No.: 594-PPCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt: 30.09.2026

CHIEF ENGINEER (P&MM)
TSPDCL, Hyderabad

ଓଡିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଚକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିମିଟେଡ୍
(ଓଡିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Jangpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007

ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)

E-TCN NO.-CPC-85/2026-27: OPTCL invites bids under single stage two part system from any bidder for Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of High Temperature Low Sag(HTLS) conductor after dismantling of ACSR Panther Conductor in existing 132kV Burla PH-Katapali Ckt-I&II line in Sambalpur District on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. The estimated cost of the tender is **Rs. 12,41,57,478/-**. The last date & time of Submission of Bid Dt. 27.10.2026 up to 12:45 P.M.

E-TCN NO.- TW-IT/OT/01/2026-27: Bids invited in e-tender mode from reputed bidders for Selection of vendor towards development of Geo-Fencing enabled iOS based mobile application in line with already developed android based OLAMP mobile application. Security audit and subsequent Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) Support for three years. The estimated cost of the tender is **Rs. 24,42,600/-**. The bid shall be due on date 22.10.2026 13:30 Hrs.

For details, visit OPTCL's official website <http://www.optcl.co.in> and www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL. HIPR-63/2026-27

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CM
YK

A BG-BGE

Srinivasan approaches Charity Commissioner against Tata trust

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

The power struggle within the Tata Trusts has taken a fresh turn with Venu Srinivasan, trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), approaching the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner demanding immediate probe into the trust's administration and governance.

Mr. Srinivasan said the move was necessary to

“preserve the institutional integrity and proper administration of SDTT.”

SDTT, the lead Tata Trust with a 27.98% stake in Tata Sons, has emerged as a key player in the ongoing developments at the group's holding company.

The second-largest trust, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which holds 23.56%, has had its voting rights effectively paralysed since May after the Charity Commissioner began exa-

mining a complaint filed earlier by Mr. Srinivasan in his capacity as an SRTT trustee.

Jeopardising status

In his complaint, Mr. Srinivasan said SDTT's growing involvement in Tata Sons' commercial and strategic decisions could jeopardise its charitable status.

“SDTT is a public charitable trust and its substantial shareholding in Tata Sons cannot result in the

Trust itself assuming the functions of a commercial enterprise or participating directly in the conduct of Tata Sons' business affairs,” he said.

Citing recent Tata Trusts announcements, Mr. Srinivasan alleged the trusts, through their chairman and operating team, had taken a direct role in identifying, negotiating and implementing major commercial decisions involving Tata Sons – activities, he

claimed, were beyond their charitable mandate.

Tax implications

He warned such a conduct could expose SDTT's charitable corpus to significant tax implications under provisions governing non-profit organisations' commercial activities.

“Such conduct constitutes mismanagement of the affairs and property of SDTT and a breach of duties owed by its trustees,”

he said.

Mr. Srinivasan also accused SDTT of attempting to influence the independent functioning of nominee directors on the Tata Sons board. Referring to SDTT's September 16 circular restraining him from participating in or voting on the proposed listing of Tata Sons, he said the move was “an extraordinary attempt to prevent me from exercising independent judgment and vote.”

The complaint seeks a probe into the appointment and continuation of Noel N. Tata as perpetual trustee and Chairman of Tata Trusts, the appointment of his son Neville N. Tata, his [Mr. Srinivasan] exclusion from related decision-making processes, and the role of SDTT trustees in Tata Sons' affairs.

Mr. Srinivasan has also sought directions preventing Mr. Noel Tata from participating in SDTT deci-

sions related to appointing or instructing Tata Sons nominees or exercising voting rights on behalf of the trust at Tata Sons' general meetings.

The confrontation follows the September 17 Tata Sons board meet where Mr. Srinivasan supported another term for chairman N. Chandrasekaran and compliance with RBI's directive on listing Tata Sons. Mr. Noel Tata had opposed both the moves.

INBRIEF



Apple Pay goes live in India with Axis Bank-issued cards

Apple launched Apple Pay in India – a payment feature that lets iPhone, iPad, and Apple Watch users make payments using Axis Bank-issued Visa and Mastercard cards. Support for Mac is coming soon, according to an official press release. With Apple Pay, users can make payments without having to type in PINs or OTPs. To make the payment, users will have to activate their devices and verify their identity if needed, before holding the device near a contactless reader. Concerning safety, Apple Pay customers' card numbers are not stored on the device or Apple servers.

RoSCTL, RoDTEP schemes extended by Union govt.

The Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry and the Ministry of Textiles have extended the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products Scheme and Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies Scheme respectively till December 31, 2026. In orders issued on September 30, the Ministries said the schemes will continue for exporters till the end of December this year without any change in the rates and structure.

Centre notifies CAFE norms, tightens PVs' fuel-efficiency targets

Tighter fuel-consumption targets from 2027-32 will also offer credits for hybrids, flex-fuel vehicles, biofuels and efficiency technologies

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Centre has notified the third phase of carbon emission norms for passenger vehicles (PVs), effective from April 1, 2027 to March 31, 2032, under which each battery electric vehicle (EV) will count as three vehicles toward a carmaker's fleet-efficiency calculation, while other cleaner technologies and biofuel-based vehicles will receive specified credits.

Under the new norms, the fuel-consumption benchmark will be tightened from 3.996 litre per 100 km in 2027-28 to 3.3273 litre per 100 km in 2031-32, amounting to an improvement of about 16.7% over the five-year period. The new norms will apply to new passenger vehicles manufactured or



New template: The norms broadly cover passenger cars, including hatchbacks, sedans and special utility vehicles. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

imported for sale in India.

The Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE) norms use 1,229 kg as the reference vehicle weight. The earlier concession for small cars weighing up to 909 kg has been removed following a pitched fight that split the auto industry.

The fleet's average fuel consumption will be calculated using the Modified Indian Driving Cycle (MIDC)

and expressed in petrol-equivalent litre per 100 km. For individual models, fuel consumption will be calculated using their notified tailpipe CO₂ emissions. Diesel, LPG, CNG and electric vehicles will be converted into petrol-equivalent figures using specified conversion factors. For electric vehicles, energy consumption will be measured in kWh per 100 km.

Trump, firms pledge AI safety; experts flag lack of enforcement

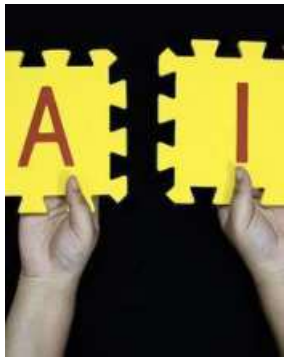
Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

U.S. President Donald Trump and the heads of six major technology firms signed a voluntary accord committing frontier AI developers to a four-layer system of safety controls, including internal monitoring, independent external evaluations and board-level oversight.

The “White House Accord on Super Intelligence: Joint Commitment on Frontier Responsibilities” was signed by Google CEO Sundar Pichai, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg, OpenAI President Greg Brockman, xAI CEO Elon Musk and Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang.

The accord says companies training and deploying frontier models should put in place internal controls to monitor models' capabilities and alignment, including risks. The controls should ensure AI models do not hack or access technical systems.

The voluntary nature of



AI developers commit to four layers of safety controls.

the commitment, however, has raised questions about how effective the framework can be.

Gaurav Vasu, founder of Unearthinsight, described the accord as a positive step, but said its effectiveness would depend on whether firms act on safety findings, when fixing a problem could delay a product launch or affect revenue.

Vaibhav Tare, Chief Information Security Officer at Fulcrum Digital, said board-level oversight was a necessary step, but AI governance could not remain limited to policy documents and periodic audits.

Cabinet okays rabi MSP hike for 2027-28

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the increase in the Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for all mandated Rabi crops for the marketing season 2027-28, with safflower receiving the biggest increase, the government announced.

“Under the leadership of PM Narendra Modi, the government has a clear policy decision that farmers should get a profit of at least 50% or more over their average cost of production,” Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said at a press conference following the Cabinet decision.

“In line with this, the MSP announced for Rabi marketing season 2027-28 carries a margin of 50% to 106% over the all-India weighted average cost of production.”

The MSP for safflower was increased by ₹675 per quintal to ₹7,215 per quintal, an increase of 10.3% over its level in the previous year.

AM Green bags €585 mn green ammonia deal

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

AM Green Ammonia (India) secured a long-term pact to supply renewable fuels of non-biological origin (RFNBO) ammonia to Germany after emerging as the sole winner of the Asian lot in the H2Global auction conducted by HINT.CO GmbH (Hintco).

Under the pact, Hintco will buy the ammonia from AM Green for a minimum value of €585 million over 10 years. The firm may also secure additional volumes quoted by AM Green, using proceeds from the resale of green ammonia in the European market.

IRDAI's new 'norms' ruffle feathers of LIC agents, broker body

N. Ravi Kumar
HYDERABAD

Voicing concerns over the impact of the reforms IRDAI is proposing to norms governing distribution, commissions and expenses, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) agents urged the insurance regulator to consider the likely repercussions on jobs and livelihoods.

Cost efficiency should not be pursued in a manner that reduces the number of active agents or makes the profession economically unsustainable. The primary objective of distribution reform should



IRDAI's proposed reforms irk LIC agents, brokers.

ultimately be to increase insurance coverage and improve policyholder outcomes, said the Life Insurance Agents' Federation of India (LIAFI) in its responses to IRDAI. Meanwhile, brokers under IBAI also expressed concern.

Govt. end-Aug. fiscal deficit hits 41.9% of 2026-27 target

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A rise in subsidy spending, particularly on fertilizers, led to the Centre's fiscal deficit touching 41.9% of budgeted target for 2026-27 as of August vis a vis 38.1% at this point last year.

Data released by the Controller General of Accounts show the Centre's total revenue stood at ₹13.7 lakh crore in April-August 2026 this financial year, while total expenditure stood at ₹20.8 lakh crore.

As of August, total capital expenditure stood at 41.7% of the budgeted target while it was 38.5% at this point last year.

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,
P.W.D. DISTT.DN.II, UDAIPUR**

No.: 891

Date: 24.09.2026

Notice Inviting Bid No. 13/2026-27
NIB No.: PWD2627A2921

Bids for ML/NP Road Yr. 2026-27 works etc. are invited from interested bidders upto 28.09.2026 10:00 AM to 12.10.2026 04:00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal ("http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in" and "http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in") of the state, and department website. The approximate value of procurement of **2 work is Rs. 316.84 Lacs.**

1. UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB13119
2. UBN No.: PWD2627WSOB13121

(Anil Khichi)
Executive Engineer,
PWD Distt.Dn.II, Udaipur

DIPR/C/16548/2026

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
PWD DIVISION BEAWAR**

Notice Inviting Bid No. 12/2026-27

Bids for **06 No. of Works** are invited from interested bidders **upto 06.00 PM 05 Oct 2026**. Other particular of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in) of the State, and DIPR departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is **Rs. 443.22 Lacs.**

S No.	NIB NO	UBIN NO	Amount (Lac)
1	PWD2627A2973	PWD2627WSOB13394	214.12
2	PWD2627A2974	PWD2627WSOB13395	113.18
3	PWD2627A2975	PWD2627WSOB13398	87.81
4	PWD2627A2976	PWD2627WSOB13399	8.63
5	PWD2627A2977	PWD2627WSOB13401	17.26
6	PWD2627A2978	PWD2627WSOB13402	2.22

(Naresh Shersiya)
Executive Engineer
PWD, Division Beawar

DIPR/C/16723/2026

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण खण्ड दूदू जिला जयपुर
पंचायत समिति परिसर दूदू, जयपुर
E-mail:- ceewdsc.dudu@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक:- 1301-1307 दिनांक: 24.09.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या- 13/2026-27
राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से मुख्यमंत्री जल स्वावलम्बन अभियान 2.0 योजना के द्वितीय तथा तृतीय चरण अन्तर्गत जिला जयपुर के ब्लॉक मौजमाबाद एवं दूदू में फार्म पौण्ड, तालाब रिनोवेशन तथा आर.टी.डब्ल्यू.एच.एस. मय दोष निवारण के लिए उपर्युक्त श्रेणी में सर्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग/जल संसाधन विभाग/ग्रामीण विकास एवं पंचायती राज विभाग में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्रीय सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/राज्य एवं दूदू संस्कार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न स्तरीय श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-टेंडरिंग प्रक्रिया द्वारा दिनांक 24.09.2026 से दिनांक 12.10.2026 को सयं 06:00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। दिनांक 13.10.2026 को सुबह 11:00 बजे कार्यालय में खोली जायेगी। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>, <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं विभागीय वेबसाइट www.watershed.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
NIB CODE:- WSC2627A1363
UBN No.:- 1. (WSC2627WSOB02436) 2. (WSC2627WSOB02437) 3. (WSC2627WSOB02438) 4. (WSC2627WSOB02439) 5. (WSC2627WSOB02440) 6. (WSC2627WSOB02441)
(प्रोति सुयन मधु)
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता
जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण
पंचायत समिति दूदू जयपुर

DIPR/C/16502/2026

CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre,
Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029

Petition No. 489/TD/2026

Dated: 29.9.2026

NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 (the Act)

An application for the grant of a Category-IV licence for inter-State trading in electricity across India has been made before the Commission by **Terra Clean Limited**, NBCC Commercial Space, 10th floor, Tower 2, Kidwai Nagar, Sarojini Nagar, South West Delhi, Delhi-110023.

2. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State trading licence to Terra Clean Limited before the Commission can be accessed at the website <https://terraceclean.in> or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.

3. On consideration of the material available on record, the Commission is satisfied that prima facie the applicant qualifies for the grant of a licence for inter-State trading in electricity and by order dated 29.9.2026, the Commission has proposed to grant a Category-IV licence to the applicant for inter-State trading in electricity across India.

4. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act to invite suggestions or objections, if any, to the proposal to grant the licence for inter-State trading in electricity as aforesaid by the Commission to be received by the undersigned latest by **21.10.2026** at the above noted address. The objections or suggestions received after the specified date shall not be considered.

5. The Commission has fixed the application for final disposal on **23.10.2026** and the person who files the suggestions or objections may in his discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Tender Notice No. 04/2026-27/CE/SE(P/EE(PD-I)/GVMC/Dt:30-09-2026

Name of Work:- Replacement of wornout pumps with Energy Efficient pumps and arrangement of SCADA for monitoring and accountability of sewer water from Viman nagar & Gopalapatnam Pump houses to fulfill the sewer water to 108 MLD STP at Narava

1. No. of Works : 1 (One)
2. Value of works (ECV) : **Rs.2.49 Crores**
3. Downloading Starting Date : 30-09-2026 @ 7.00 PM
4. Downloading End Date : 08-10-2026 @ 3.00 PM
5. Last date for Submission of bid : 08-10-2026 @ 4.00 PM

Further details at <http://www.appeprocurement.gov.in>
O/o the Executive Engineer (PD-I) Division:9848308824 **For Commissioner**

BHARAT ELECTRONICS LIMITED
(A Group of Public Enterprises under the Ministry of Defence)
(CIN: L32309KA1954G000767)

Bharat Electronics Limited, Bengaluru Complex, Jalahalli Post, Bengaluru - 560 013, invites applications for empanelment of reputed and experienced agencies for “Registration of Contractors for Civil / Composite Works and Various Category of Works”.

For pre-qualification criteria and other details visit website <https://eprocurebel.co.in>. All Corrigendum / Amendments / Changes, if any will be issued and made available on Website <https://eprocurebel.co.in>. No Corrigendum / Amendments / Changes will be issued in Newspapers. Hence, prospective agencies are advised to keep visiting the Website <https://eprocurebel.co.in> on regular basis.

Sd/-
DR. GEN. MANAGER
(SAMVIDA & KRYA / ES)

DATE : 01.10.2026

'Har Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam'

Cabinet approves ₹1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet announced the third phase of the Green Energy Corridor (GEC) that seeks to integrate up to 135 gigawatts of renewable energy into grids across States and Union Territories by fiscal year 2032-33.

The scheme would further strive to address curtailment, that is a situation when grid operators limit the power output from



Power play: About ₹1.36 lakh crore would be spent on developing intra-state transmission systems in phase 3. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

renewable sources to maintain grid stability.

The Hindu had reported

August 10 that the government was in the final planning stages of instituting

the third phase of the GEC.

Project outlay

The third phase of the scheme accounts for a total project outlay of more than ₹1.86 lakh crore.

This comprises ₹1.36 lakh crore for developing intra-state transmission systems in the third phase. As a first, the latest phase of GEC also provisions a ₹50,000-crore dedicated component for deploying 50 GWh of battery energy storage system (BESS).

REALLY SPECIAL

Sahil thrilled at making the grade for the Los Angeles Olympics



R.V. MOORTHY

It's a big thing for me to win an Asian Games gold and get an Olympic quota for the country. That is what every athlete dreams of... going to the Olympics, representing your country, winning medals. To do so here in my first Asian Games feels really special — Sahil Jadhav, who won the mixed and men's team gold medals.

IDEAL FOIL

Kynan kept pushing me to deliver my best, says Neeru



PTI

Indian shooter Neeru Dhandha credited Kynan Chenai and her team for keeping her motivated enough to shoot a decent score in the trap mixed team event. "All through the qualifying and final, Kynan kept encouraging me, pushing me to do my best even when I struggled to score. It helped a lot".

ON THE BALL

Pranavi second among women as the Indian golfers begin well



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Pranavi Urs fired a four-under 66 to lie second in the individual standings while the Indian women were tied sixth after the first round at the Asian Games. With the two best scores counting towards the team competition, India posted a score of three-under. Among men, Saptak Talwar shot a four-under 66 to lie tied third.

EASY OUTING

Indian squash teams advance to the semifinals, assured of medals



X@INDIASQUASH

The Indian men's and women's squash teams eased into the Asian Games semifinals with wins over Kuwait and Singapore respectively, assuring themselves of a medal in Nagoya on Wednesday. **The results: Quarterfinals: Men:** India 2 bt Kuwait 0. **Women:** India 2 bt Singapore 0 .

Indian archers hit the bullseye with three gold medals

The exploits of the men's, women's and mixed compound teams lift the pall of gloom that had enveloped the contingent after an underwhelming campaign so far; the overall tally rises to 60

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

For two weeks, the Indian contingent had flattered to deceive, falling short of expectations and medals. All this while, the archers had remained in the shadows, focussed on the big picture.

That picture burst into a 1000 colours on a bright, sunny Wednesday morning in Aichi-Nagoya as the compound archers retained three of the five gold medals from the last edition — the men's, women's and mixed team — along with a quota for the Los Angeles Olympics. The individual matches are scheduled for Thursday.

India's golden haul coincided with the sky clearing up over the city after four days of non-stop rains and overcast conditions, much like the gloom in the Indian contingent so far over a lack of medals.

The Okazaki Chuo Sogo



Triple treat: The women's trio of Prithika, Chikitha and Jyothi, mixed duo of Sahil and Chikitha and men's team of Kushal, Sahil and Ganesh struck the yellow metal. R.V. MOORTHY

Park Multipurpose Square was rife with excitement as the Indian trio of Jyothi Surekha, Chikitha Taniparthi and Prithika Pradeep walked out for their semifinal against powerhouse Korea, knowing well this would be a much sterner test than perhaps even the final.

Both teams started cautiously with a 59 each in the opening round. Things turned from the second,

when India got another 59 while Yerin Park struck two nines and Jungyoon Park and Yeonsoo Kang got one each for a round of 56 and a three-point lead to India.

Korea looked like fighting back with a perfect 60 in the third round to India's 58 but the one-point advantage carried over into the decider.

Prithika had just one nine, on her first arrow, fol-

lowed by all perfect targets thereafter. Jyothi needed a nine or better on the final shot and she managed exactly that to win 234-233.

India was always in control in the final against China, starting with a perfect 60 to take a two-point lead after the first round and extending it with a 59 to 58 in the second.

China reduced the margin by one in the third and managed a 58 in the final

round which left India needing only a combined total of 57 or more to win; they did better with a perfect 60 to win 238-234, equalling the world, Asian and Games records in the process.

Chikitha then combined with Sahil Jadhav to win the mixed team event in a shoot-off against Korea after the two were tied on 157 at the end of regulation shots.

India started with perfect 40s in the first two rounds while Jungyoon Park and Yonghee Choi both missed one shot apiece in each round for two 39s.

Korea clawed back over the next two rounds but Chikitha kept her nerves in the shoot-off.

The day's final gold came when Sahil combined with Ganesh Thirumuru and Kushal Dalal to

first demolish the Koreans in the semifinals 236-229 and then overturned a two-point deficit against China in the final to win 238-237.

China started strongly, taking a two-point lead after the first round with a 60 and nines from Kushal and Ganesh. India pulled one back in Round 3 when Jinyi Liu's nine on the 14th arrow hurt China. India won 238-237.

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	151	67	59	277
2	Japan	50	77	73	200
3	South Korea	24	30	49	103
4	Uzbekistan	16	19	19	54
5	Thailand	12	10	12	34
8	India	10	21	29	60

Neeru-Kynan duo claims the trap mixed team gold



A moment to savour: Neeru, right, and Kynan celebrate their triumph. PTI

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

On Tuesday, Neeru Dhandha fought her opponents and the elements to win India's first and only individual gold so far in shooting. On Wednesday, she found the perfect foil in Kynan Chenai, the senior pro backing the youngster all the way as the two combined to win the trap mixed team gold with a new Asian record score.

Kynan put his individual disappointment behind and took charge of the proceedings even as Neeru, struggling to recover from being in the heavy downpour all day on Tuesday, felt physically unable to sustain the pressure, struggling to get the big scores she is known for.

The duo shot two consecutive series of 46 and then a 44 to advance as the

fourth and final qualifiers with a total of 136. While Kynan scored an impressive 73 out of a maximum of 75, Neeru stumbled in the final series with only a 19 after two series of 22s for a total of 63 but it was good enough to get into the final.

The final, though, was a complete contrast with the Indians taking charge early on and then staying on top all the way.

Kynan missed his first and only target of the final, being spot-on thereafter, scoring 19 out of a maximum 20 points.

Neeru managed 15 but it was good enough. India started with a six in the first series, followed it up with a perfect 10 to be tied with Qatar at top on 16 points. Another series of 10 put India two clear after Qatar's 8 and the difference remained till the

end, India finished on top with a 34

"You have no idea how happy I was it wasn't raining. It helped out with the targets also, it wasn't so difficult to see. Initially it was a bit tough but it brightened up towards the end of the final. Thank God it wasn't raining otherwise it would just been miserable." Kynan admitted but insisted that the conditions didn't really matter in terms of competition.

"I think more than anything else, the chase for the medal was more inspiring. As shotgun shooters, we don't really have a choice: other than lightning, we shoot in every type of condition, so we just become used to it. Having the national anthem played for you is something special and today, one of my dreams came true," he added.

Sunil bags bronze

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Sunil Kumar became the first Indian Greco-Roman wrestler to win two Asian Games medals after clinching a bronze in the men's 87kg event while Nisha Dahiya was knocked out on the opening day of the competition here on Wednesday.

Sunil, who had secured bronze in Hangzhou, assured his place on the podium with a technical superiority win (9-0) over Philippines' Roberts Calum Johnston. Locking his rival's right arm, the Indian effected two take downs to quickly open up a 4-0 lead. Johnston was put on ground in 'Par Terre' position, from where Sunil made more scoring moves to finish the bout in the first period itself.

The 27-year-old was left to fight for a bronze medal



Sunil... on top. REUTERS

after losing his semifinal 0-11 to Japan's Taizo Yoshida by technical superiority.

Disappointment was in store for Nisha, who blew away a lead in both her women's 68kg bouts to make an early exit.

Nisha lost to North Korea's Pak Sol Gum in the 1/8 phase — on bigger scoring move criterion — and went down to South Korea's Park Hyeonyeong 'by fall' in the repechage round.

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Wednesday:

Archery: Finals: Compound: Men's team: bt China; Women's team: bt China; Mixed team: bt South Korea.

Boxing: Semifinals: Women: 75kg: Lovlina bt Bogdanova (Kaz); 60kg: Priya lost to Chengyu (Chn), bagged bronze; Men: 90kg: Kapil lost to Khabibullaev (Uzb), bagged bronze.

Golf: Individual (round 1): Men: Saptak (T3), Veer and Yuvraj (T23); Women: Pranavi (second), Diksha and Aditi (T18).

Hockey: Women (semifinal): bt South Korea 2-0.

Shooting: Trap mixed team final: Neeru & Kynan (gold); 25m rapid fire pistol men individual

qualification (stage 1): Anish (fifth).

Squash: Quarterfinals: Women's team: bt Singapore 2-0; Men's team: bt Kuwait 2-0.

Tennis: Men: Third round: Dhakshineswar lost to Chun-hsin (Tpe) 3-6, 4-6; Nagal bt Fomin (Uzb) 6-3, 6-2; Doubles (quarterfinals): Anirudh & Sriram Balaji lost to Fumin & Tianhui (Chn) 7-6(4), 6-7(7), [8-10]; Yuki & Dhakshineswar lost to Chenjui & Yu-hsiou (Tpe) 6-7(5), 3-6. Mixed doubles (second round): Rutuja & Yuki lost to Su-wei & Chun-hsin (Tpe) 3-6, 4-6.

Wrestling: Men's Greco-Roman 87kg bronze medal match: Sunil bt Roberts (Phi); Women's 68kg repechage: Nisha lost to Hyeonyeong (Kor).

Lovlina advances to final; Priya, Kapil earn bronze

Press Trust of India
NISHIO (JAPAN)

Lovlina Borgohain scripted history by becoming the first Indian woman boxer to reach back-to-back Asian Games finals, while debutants Priya Ghanghas and Kapil Pokhariya claimed bronze medals here on Wednesday.

Last edition's silver medalist Lovlina edged reigning 70kg world champion Natalya Bogdanova of Kazakhstan 3-2 in a closely fought 75kg semifinal to assure herself of at least a silver.

However, 20-year-old Priya, making her Asian Games debut, went down 1-4 to former world champion Yang Chengyu of China in a bruising 60kg semifinal.

Another Indian debutant, Kapil suffered a similar 1-4 defeat against reigning world champion Turabek Khabibullaev of Uzbekistan in the 90kg semifinal and had to be content with a bronze.

India will thus have three boxers — Lovlina, Parveen Hooda (65kg) and Ankush Panghal (80kg) fighting for gold on Friday.

Indian boxers have already bettered their medal tally from the previous edition, with six medals assured this time compared to four in 2023, when they won one silver and three bronze.

Alongside Priya and Kapil, super-heavyweight boxer Narendra Berwal



Priya... podium finish on Games debut. SAI MEDIA



Kapil. SAI MEDIA

will also go home with a bronze medal.

Lovlina overcame a slow start to edge past Kazakhstan's Bogdanova in a closely fought contest, with a dominant second round proving decisive.

Good experience

"It was a good experience because this is my second Asian Games, and last time I had a silver medal. So this time I will definitely try to get a gold medal. Let's see what happens in the final," Lovlina said.

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Thursday (all times IST):

Archery: Compound women's individual: Quarterfinal: Chikitha vs. Ashrafah (Ina), 5.30 a.m.; semifinal, 6.35 a.m.; final, 7.10 a.m.; Compound men's individual: Quarterfinal: Ganesh vs. Chen (Tpe), 9.45 a.m.; semifinal, 10.35 a.m.; final, 11.10 a.m.

Cricket: Men (semifinal): vs. Sri Lanka, 10 a.m.

Hockey: Men (semifinal): vs. Pakistan, 1 p.m.

Shooting: 25m rapid fire pistol men individual qualification (stage 2) — Anish, 6.10 a.m.; final, noon.

Squash: Semifinals: Women's team: vs. Hong Kong, 7 a.m.; Men's team: vs. Malaysia, 1 p.m.

Tennis: Men (quarterfinal): Nagal vs. Yibing (Chn), noon.

Volleyball: Men (quarterfinal): vs. Pakistan, 6.30 a.m.

Wrestling: Men's Greco-Roman 77kg (1/8 finals): Aman vs. Tuvshinbaatar (Mgl), 7.20 a.m.; Women's 62kg (1/8 finals): Mansi vs. Irina (Kaz), 7.30 a.m.; Men's Greco-Roman: 60kg (1/4 finals): Sumit vs. TBC, 7.55 a.m.; 97kg (1/4 finals): Nitesh vs. Agamammedov (Tkm), 8.15 a.m.

INBRIEF



Vaishnavi scalps six as India-A takes control of ‘Test’

Vaishnavi Sharma's haul of six for 52 handed India-A a huge advantage as the hosts led Australia-A by 322 runs at stumps on day two of the only women's "Test" here on Wednesday.

The scores: India-A 364 in 103.3 overs (Shubha Satheesh 59, Tanisha Singh 92, Niki Prasad 91; Lilly Mills 4/98, Charli Knott 3/82) & 134/2 in 27.5 overs (Priya Punia 59, Yastika Bhatia 33 n.o) vs Australia-A 176 in 63.4 overs (Rachel Trenaman 45; Vaishnavi Sharma 6/52).

ICC World Cup 2027 schedule to be announced today

The International Cricket Council (ICC) will unveil the schedule for the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2027 in Cape Town on Thursday. It will mark the one-year countdown to the tournament, which will commence on October 2, 2027, with the final scheduled for Sunday, November 21, 2027. The event will also see the opening of the ticket ballot for fans, as per a press release.

Brazil's Raphinha out of India clash with injury

Raphinha was released by Brazil on Wednesday because of a thigh injury. The Brazilian Football Confederation said Raphinha had a minor muscle edema and no replacement player will be called up for the friendly match against India.

LIVE TELECAST

Irani Cup: day 1, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

India-A vs Australia-A: Second 'Test' day 3, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

Cricket: Asian Games (Men): India vs Sri Lanka, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

Football: Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 8.30 p.m.

Cricket: Men's ODI WC schedule unveil, Star Sports 1, 2 & Jio-Hotstar, 8.30 p.m.

Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & JioHotstar, 5.30 a.m. (Friday)

Srinagar in focus as J&K aims to set the tone against Rol



Gearing up: The Rest of India players will be keen to lay down an early marker. IMRAN NISSAR

IRANI CUP

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

Wherever one's gaze turns in Srinagar, there are attractions aplenty. Not for nothing does the moniker of 'Paradise on Earth' adorn Kashmir. There is the serene Dal Lake, where *shikara* rides run from dawn to dusk.

There is the dense covering of *chinar* trees, whose leaves will morph into a canvas of crimson before carpeting the turf at the culmination of autumn.

For connoisseurs of food and drink, the multi-course *wazwan* meal and the piping hot *kahwa* tea are must-haves.

Seldom, though, has cricket figured prominently in conversations here. Sure, two ODIs were held in the 1980s at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium – the first between India and West Indies in 1983 left a

bitter taste as an unruly crowd dug up the pitch – but India's northernmost region was always on the margins of the country's cricketing map.

Not anymore. Undeniable proof comes this week as the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium, nestled in the foothills of the Zabarwan mountain range, hosts arguably its biggest cricketing contest since the 1980s.

From Thursday, Jammu & Kashmir will take on the Rishabh Pant-led Rest of India in the Irani Cup here. The recognition is by virtue of J&K holding aloft the Ranji Trophy for the first time in 2025-26.

The interest for the fixture was palpable on Wednesday afternoon. As both teams wrapped up their practice sessions, a queue of fans, comprising youngsters largely, patiently lined up outside one of the side gates in the hunt for passes.

When the action begins, there are players on both sides with plenty to gain.

For J&K, the curiosity revolves around how it responds to the tag of the Ranji champion.

In the Rest of India camp, there is a nice blend of proven performers like Pant and Sarfaraz Khan and young talents like Manav Suthar and Shikhar Mohan. If the contest can be as arresting as the sights of Srinagar, the city's long wait for a high-profile contest would have been worth it.

The teams (from): Jammu & Kashmir: Paras Dogra (Capt.), Shubham Khajuria, Qamran Iqbal, Yawer Hassan, Shubham Pundir, Abdul Samad, Kawalpreet Singh, Kanhaiya Wadhawan (wk), Abid Mushtaq, Sahil Lotra, Vanshaj Sharma, Sunil Kumar, Umar Nazir, Lone Nasir Muzaffar, Rohit Sharma.

Rest of India: Rishabh Pant (Capt. & wk), Sanat Sangwan, Sudip Gharami, Sarfaraz Khan, Ayush Doseja, R. Smaran, Shikhar Mohan, Aryan Juyal (wk), Anukul Roy, Manav Suthar, Saransh Jain, Akash Deep, Mukesh Kumar, Mukesh Choudhary, Aryan Pandey.

India-A in trouble as the top-order fails to get going

AUS-A IN INDIA

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

Neither Devdutt Padikkal (31, 46b, 4x4) nor B. Sai Sudharsan could bail India-A out from a batting slump, and the host had its back to the wall against Australia-A after the second day of the second "Test" at the Siechem Cricket Stadium here on Wednesday.

The internationals had chipped in with runs in the first game, but Todd Murphy (two for 26) and Corey Rocchiccioli snared them and hit the spine of this Indian batting line-up. India-A was 122 for five at stumps, still 236 behind the visitors.

Rocchiccioli, with his tall release and flight, had already got deliveries to misbehave with extra bounce.

With Sai Sudharsan pushed into his crease to tackle this trepidation, the gambit was completed by Murphy, who fired a delivery full, got it to turn low and crash into the off-stump.

Padikkal was helpless to a similar delivery from Rocchiccioli.

Shaik Rasheed (36 batting, 140b, 2x4), seeing the slide, opted to stonewall to survive till stumps.

The scores: Australia-A 358 in 116.3 overs (Jason Sangha 46, Sam Harper 128) vs. India-A 122/5 in 51 overs.

SNAPSHOTS



Lightning quick: Yamal scores Spain's opener after just 75 seconds against Croatia. AFP

Spain brushes aside Croatia

PARIS: Lamine Yamal netted a brace as world champion Spain continued its winning start to the UEFA Nations League with a 4-1 success in Seville against Croatia on Tuesday, while Harry Kane scored as England won in Czechia.

The results: League A: Group 3: Spain 4 (Yamal 2, 63, Pubill 31, Williams 89) bt Croatia 1 (Beljo 28); Czechia 0 lost to England 2 (Gordon 47, Kane 69).

Mortara and de Vries to stay on at Mahindra Racing

CHENNAI: Indian team Mahindra Racing has retained Edoardo Mortara and Nyck de Vries for the upcoming 2026/27 FIA Formula E World Championship season.

Since joining Mahindra Racing in 2023, Mortara and de Vries have played a pivotal role in the team's progression and development over the past three seasons and, together, have secured two victories, 10 additional podium finishes, and six pole positions.

Spain brushes aside Croatia

BENGALURU: Anvay Dravid, the son of former India captain Rahul Dravid, will captain the Karnataka team for the Vinoo Mankad (under-19) Trophy which will commence at Visakhapatnam on October 8.

The squad: Anvay Dravid (Captain), Nitish Arya, Dhruv Krishnan, Rohith Reddy, S.J. Aadharsh, Sujay Konwar, Varun Patel, Aniketh Reddy, Tejas Reddy, Samarth Kulkarni, C. Vaibhav, Gaurav Venkatesh, B.R. Rathana, Preetham Raj, Dhyaan Hiremath.

Head coach: Kunal Kapoor, **Bowling coach:** Raajjoo Bhatkal.

MEG & Centre FC pips Kodagu FC in seven goal thriller

MEG & Centre FC edged out Kodagu FC 4-3 in the Karnataka Super Division football league here on Wednesday.

The results: Roots FC 3 (G. Suresh 53, V. Darshan 65, Madhialagan 80) bt Sporting Club Bengaluru 3 (O.M. Asif 11, 48, K. John 83); MEG & Centre FC 4 (Shaik Muzeeb 1, Ayush 28, 77, L. Haakip 39) bt Kodagu FC 3 (Jithu 18, R. Shaiza 61, S. Rani 84); United Stars FC 2 (D. Akash 31, A. Ajay 71) bt Technico FF 1 (Nathan Akash Powell 61).

India breaks down a stubborn Korea

Ishika and Salima sound the board in the space of four minutes to put the women's hockey team one step away from regaining gold

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
GIFU



Finally there: India struggled with penalty corner conversion before Ishika broke the deadlock. AHF

India started on an aggressive note and had its chance, the first of its 10 penalty corners coming in the fourth minute, but Deepika's shot was saved. The sequence was repeated several times through the match – India's PC, Korea's defending and stalemate. For

a long time, it looked like Korea was content simply sitting back and defending.

There was barely any attempt to attack or even break into the Indian third. At times, the Indians, too, were clueless on how to proceed against an opponent which did little by way of action. Most of the contest was confined to the Korean half as India tried to find the opening goal.

The deadlock was finally broken in the 44th minute when Ishika turned in a perfectly-placed pass off India's eighth PC with a reverse shot.

Four minutes later, Salima Tete's cross from the right deflected off a defender's stick and trickled past the goal line. Korea looked to have realised that there

was no way back from there without moving up and creating a few chances of its own, which included three back-to-back PCs. But it could not get past Savita Punia.

It was a similar story in the other semifinal except that Japan was successful in keeping China at bay for the entire 60 minutes before going down in the shootout.

Friday's final, however, is expected to be a very different affair with both India and China known for playing a more open game than what was on display on Wednesday.

The results (semifinals): India 2 (Ishika 44, Salima Tete 48) bt South Korea 0; China 0 drew with Japan 0. *China won 4-2 in shootout.*

Stud Poker appeals most in Mysore 2000 Guineas

RACING

MYRSURU: Stud Poker, who is in fine nick, may score an encore in the Zavaray S. Poonawalla Mysore 2000 Guineas 2026 (1,600m), the chief event of the races to be held here on Thursday (Oct 1). There will be no false rails.

1 ORIGINAL VEL RACING TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,400m), maiden 3-y-o only, (Terms), 2-00 p.m.: 1. Military Code (7) B.R. Kumar 56, 2. Routing Run (6) Darshan 56, 3. Tiger Mac (9) A. Baandal 56, 4. Amber Storm (5) Neeraj 54.5, 5. Executive One (1) R. Pradeep 54.5, 6. Love On (4) Vinod Shinde 54.5, 7. Love True (10) Inayat 54.5, 8. Osaka (3) Akshay K 54.5, 9. Sigrid (8) Antony 54.5 and 10. Your Sri Shakti (2) Rafique S.K 54.5.

1. SIGRID, 2. OSAKA, 3. AMBER STORM

2 NAINITAL PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200m), rated 20 to 45, 5-y-o & over, 2:30: 1. True Gold (3) S.G. Prasad 60, 2. Makoto (4) Kiran Rai 59, 3. Amazing Attraction (9) Jagadeesh 58.5, 4. Aviothick (7) Jitendra S 58.5, 5. My Solitaire (10) Antony 58.5, 6. Sandal Queen (5) Rajesh K 58.5, 7. Jailer (6) R. Pradeep 57.5, 8. Star Symphony (1) L.A. Rozario 57.5, 9. My Life My Rules (2) B. Darshan 55.5 and 10. Rock My Heart (8) Ankil Pal 55.

1. STAR SYMPHONY, 2. JAILER, 3. MY SOLITAIRE

3 ORIGINAL VEL RACING TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,400m), maiden 3-y-o only, (Terms), 3-00: 1. Edison (6) N.S. Parmar 56, 2. Shining Path (-) (-) 56, 3. The Archer (5) Trevor 56, 4. Xanthos (2) Darshan 56, 5. Evolvita (4) Kiran Rai 54.5, 6. Garzian (10) Neeraj 54.5, 7. Moon Oracle (1) Akshay K 54.5, 8. Sensuous (8) Suraj 54.5, 9. Sindoor (9) Aleemuddin 54.5, 10. Tejash (7) Vinod Shinde 54.5 and 11. Zeitegeist (3) Shreyas S 54.5.

1. MOON ORACLE, 2. GARZIAN, 3. SENSUOUS

4 HOTEL RRR TROPHY (1,400m), rated 40 to 65, 3-30: 1. Spectacular (9) B. Darshan

Sassy Sarah claims the feature event

MYRSURU: Prasanna Kumar-trained Sassy Sarah (Trevor up) won the M.W. Chinnappa Memorial Trophy, the feature event of the races held here on Wednesday (Sept. 30). The winner is owned by Mr. K. Manoj Kumar, Mr. K. Harish Nayak & Mr. H.J. Balram.

THE RESULTS:

1. SRIRANGAPATTANA PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200M): DAVIDS DELIGHT (S. Sachin) 1, City Of Hustle (B. Dharshan) 2, Seductive (Md. Talib) 3 and Brocton (Ayaz Khan) 4. Not run: Zebula. 1-1/4, 1-1/4 and 3/4. Im, 12.15s. £38 (w), 19, 18 and 13 (p), SHP: 50, THP: 38, FP: 1,356, Q: 227, Trinella: 822/315, Exacta: 2,201/1,297. Favourite: Seductive. Owner: Mr. Sunil Santhosh Ser Rao. Trainer: R. Hellel Moses.

2. MEERUT PLATE (1,400M): SUPREME SUCCESS (Darshan) 1, Tricon Falcon (Md. Talib) 2, Rocking Star (S.G. Prasad) 3 and Eminent Gold (Neeraj) 4. 3/4, 1-1/4 and 1/2. Im, 24.19s. £111 (w), 30, 30 and 14 (p), SHP: 83, THP: 62, FP: 9,275 (c/o), Q: 2,651, Trinella: 13,723/11,762, Exacta: 34,823 (c/o). Favourite: Act Of Kindness. Owner: Mr. K.N. Ramaraju. Trainer: S. Narredu.

3. SRIRANGAPATTANA PLATE (DIV. I) (1,200M): OCEAN OF GRACE (B. Dharshan) 1, Golden Stride (Rafique S.K) 2, War Emblem (Abhishek Mhatre) 3 and Fashionista (Lave Kumar) 4. 5, 3-3/4 and Shd. Im, 12.07s. £25 (w), 15, 10 and 38 (p), SHP: 41, THP: 71, FP: 78, Q: 47, Trinella: 465/288, Exacta: 2,536/668. Favourite: Golden Stride. Owner: Mr. Jose Joseph. Trainer: J. Ganesh.

4. CIVIL SERVICES TROPHY (1,400M): VIBRANT QUEEN (A. Hangal) 1, Gloriousness (Darshan) 2, Viva (S. Sachin) 3 and N R I Victory (Vinod Shinde) 4. Not run: Splendid Dream. 3, 2 1/2 and 3-1/4. Im, 10.05s. £44 (w), 18, 14 and 15 (p), SHP: 40, THP: 46, FP: 213, Q: 108, Trinella: 619/238, Exacta: 18,068 (c/o). Favourite: Waitara. Owner: Mr. V. Shankar. Trainer: K. Pradeep Annaiah.

5. M.W. CHINNAPPA MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,400M): SASSY SARAH (Trevor) 1, Aquatic (Lave Kumar) 2, Irish Coffee (Antony) 3 and The Flying Fleet (Rafique S.K) 4. Not run: Red Falcon, Mind Games and Oeud De Lion. 1-3/4, 1 and 3-3/4. Im, 23.48s. £23 (w), 10, 12 and 10 (p), SHP: 26, THP: 39, FP: 158, Q: 52, Trinella: 77/25, Exacta: 557/549. Favourite: Irish Coffee.

Owners: Mr. K. Manoj Kumar, Mr. K. Harish Nayak & Mr. H.J. Balram. Trainer: Prasanna Kumar.

6. SON OF THE LIGHT PLATE (1,600M): MISTER BROWN (Antony) 1, Final Call (Akshay K) 2, The Leader (Trevor) 3 and Magnus (Neeraj) 4. 2-1/4, 2-1/2 and 3-1/4. Im, 35.68s. £17 (w), 10, 11 and 16 (p), SHP: 30, THP: 40, FP: 47, Q: 28, Trinella: 84/27, Exacta: 262/192. Favourite: Mister Brown.

Owner: Mr. G. Santhosh. Trainer: K. Pradeep Annaiah.

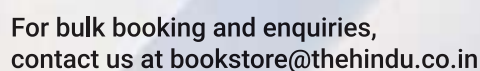
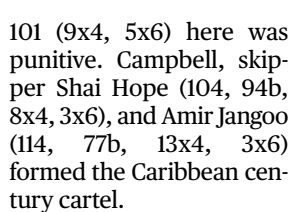
7. PENAMBUR PLATE (1,100M): ADMIRAL SHAW (Inayato 1, Excellent Warrior (Md. Talib) 2, Secret Shadow (R. Rakesh) 3 and The Grey Geranium (Sai Kumar) 4. 2-3/4, Nose and 1-3/4. Im, 05.66s. £79 (w), 14, 20 and 29 (p), SHP: 40, THP: 48, FP: 241, Q: 323, Trinella: 2,706/2,609, Exacta: 19,073/4,087. Favourite: The Grey Geranium.

Owners: Dr. Ganesan Subramanian & Mrs. Jiby Joji. Trainer: J. Sebastian.

Jackpot: ₹32,668; Runner-up: 625; Mini Jackpot: 884 (c/o); Treble (0): 1,391 (c/o); (ii): 921.

The skipper's stroke-filled knock and his mammoth opening stand with Rohit power the second highest run-chase in ODIs; centuries by WI batters Campbell, Hope and Jango go in vain

New Chandigarh, 2 p.m.





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From shooting at haystacks to shooting for gold

Every archer knows the wait between release and arrival, that held breath when nothing can be changed and everything is decided. For Chikitha, the wait lasted years. It began in a backyard, ran through lockdowns and a snapped bowstring, and ended in Aichi-Nagoya with a double triumph



REUTERS & PTI

Anirudh Velamuri

The two gold medals she has snapped up at the 2026 Asian Games have catapulted the extremely shy compound archer Chikitha Taniparthi into the national headlines. The 21-year-old, who hails from a modest farming family in Peddapalli in Telangana, is a stranger to stardom and the sprinkling of opulence that sporting achievements usually carry along in India.

There are no fancy routines or competition-day playlists yet. She doesn't even carry a pair of earphones. All she has is a burning hunger to become India's most decorated archer ever. And she's off to quite a start.

For all the reticence, Chikitha - a huge Mahesh Babu fan - finds inspiration in films that are of a more audacious ilk.

"There was a movie Ram Charan did last year called Game Changer. After watching that - and it usually happens when I watch certain films - I thought, what should I do or learn from this? I myself should change the game where I am," Chikitha told *The Hindu* a few weeks before setting out to Japan for the Asiad.

"Now, everyone says, whatever rank Chikitha is in, she will somehow change the game and come up. Similarly, I watched a film called Biker, where the message blared, 'No fear.' It all registers somewhere."

Of betrayal and faith

That itch to push beyond the ordinary is a Taniparthi family trait. Her father, Srinivas Rao - a huge sports enthusiast - combed newspapers for summer camps his own childhood never offered.

"Naanna (father) didn't have any such facilities when he was growing up, so he was keen to ensure that I had access to all that, within our means."

In school, Chikitha tried her hand at a multitude of options including volleyball, badminton, basketball and kho kho. But Srinivas wanted his child to pursue an individual discipline. Towards that end, she earned a black belt in karate. But archery was destined to be the one to stick with.

"Team sports are riddled with politics. Since archery is an individual game, whatever we do is directly visible and we do what we do for ourselves."

The year was 2018. Chikitha's uncle, on her father's request, had got her a recurve bow from Decathlon with which she trained behind her house, shooting at haystacks. Eventually, she and a few of her classmates went to the Police Training Center to try and find a coach to teach them. There, someone asked her to switch to a compound bow and took money from Srinivas for the same, only to disappear without a trace.

Disappointed but not disillusioned, the father and daughter persisted with the sport. Chikitha moved away from recurve and towards compound.

"Recurve bow needs a lot of practice and power. You need to train every single day. If you return after resting for a few days, you'll see so many changes and will have to rework it all. With compound, I could train for two hours each in the morning and evening. It needed the archer to set themselves mentally and keep getting better."

The next pursuit became trying to purchase a compound bow, but the COVID-19 pandemic arrived soon after.

"Our classes all went online, so I could train every day. At that point I didn't know what a national medal was, but I wanted to win one."

"During Covid, my father had set up a target and a 50m path so I could shoot. He would go to the field every morning. My brother and I would go running every morning along the edges of our field. That is when I became really fit. In fact, my father also joined us and improved," Chikitha recalled.

"Eventually I left for Sonipat, and my father settled back into the duties of the house. The family's fitness streak sort of snapped there."

Srinivas pushed beyond his means to support his daughter's dream. He even sold the family's paddy harvester. Meanwhile, YouTube videos formed the bedrock of Chikitha's technical base, and one of the archers she grew to idolise - Abhishek Verma - would become her mentor.

Eventually, the District Collector's office sanctioned funds for a compound bow. As she looked for a coach and a good training centre, Chikitha chanced upon the contact details of My Choice Archery Store, an equipment outlet run by Abhishek and his wife Sonali in New Delhi.

Guiding light

"I got her number from the shop they run and I knew she was Abhishek anna's wife. He and his coach (Lokesh Chand Pal)



agreed to take me in for training at the Yamuna Sports Complex for five days."

This was in August 2021. As the world found a way to open up again, so did Chikitha's prospects as an archer. Her uncle chipped in with funds for the trip to the capital.

There, Abhishek told Srinivas to leave Chikitha's well-being to him.

The first goal was a sub-junior medal.

"I didn't know much about archery, but I used to watch Abhishek anna's videos and check with my father if I was getting things right. Anna then told me that my strength was good, but he changed my anchor technique."

"In the mornings, he used to let me shoot 50-100 arrows. In the evenings, there would be no shooting. We just trained holding the bow and arrow in place. This was to develop patience. I learnt all my basics there at the Yamuna Sports Complex."

Chikitha entered the senior nationals in preparation for the sub-junior event and got a very low score there. Her mentor had notes, and the pair eventually struck off the first box in what would become a long checklist of turfs to conquer.

She then participated in selection trials to make it to the Sports Authority of India's National Centre of Excellence in Sonipat. There, coach Vivek Kumar took her under his wing.

"After my father, he is the only person I open up to after tournaments and cry with," Chikitha said.

"In 2021, I was in Hyderabad for the National Ranking Archery Tournament. Abhishek told me that there was a talented girl I should meet. Her father brought her to the hotel we were staying in. This girl was so small and frail. I asked her if she wanted to go to Sonipat. She nodded in agreement, but there were tears too," Vivek told *The Hindu*.

Nonetheless, he persisted. "If a player like Abhishek recommends someone, you cannot ignore that. He told us she would become a good archer like Jyothi Surekha."

Abhishek, it turned out, was right. The parallels between Chikitha and Jyothi are endless. Both are introverts by nature,

content to shuttle between the training field and the gym. Both follow instructions to the letter, even when that means shooting 300-odd arrows, and both are always early, rain or shine.

Vivek remembers Chikitha clinging to her father until the moment they parted. Slowly, Sonipat won her over. By night, she had found the courage to make a request: biryani. The coaches understood how hard it is for someone from South India to move to a diet where rotis reign, and they indulged her.

Any doubts about her potential evaporated at the trials ahead of the 2022 Asian Games. She missed qualification but finished a commendable seventh, enough to convince her coaches that she could be shaped into an athlete who would make India proud on the global stage.

Ask Chikitha why she likes archery and three bullet points follow. "First, because, as my dad wanted, it's an individual sport. Second, archery is a sport where I can concentrate and focus with no distractions. Third, Anna told me, 'You are a champion, and you will continue to be.'"

Others' faith in her sowed the seeds of Chikitha's ambitions; formal training is teaching her to nurture them herself. That process has not been without its hiccups. In 2024, Chikitha struggled to place among the top 16 and had lost motivation mid-season.

"That period was a struggle and I couldn't accept it. Before the national games, I wanted to get selected, but I was nowhere near the top. I was working with high poundage, and I said if I hit any more (shooting arrows), I might get injured. I didn't feel like shooting. It took me some time to recover from that. I went to Tirupati, tonsured my head, prayed very hard," she recalled.

Through every hardship, Chikitha never once thought of abandoning archery.

When her first substantial prize money arrived, after the 2023 National Games in Goa, she spent it on arrows, stockpiled for practice. A fresh set every few months is her idea of a treat.

"It is not about the money; it does not matter as long as the results come my way."

Ask Chikitha what she is proud of and, along with the golds, she may mention the gift of deep sleep. Thunder can rattle every window, but she will slumber on.

"I don't get sleep only when thoughts come to me, which happens when everything is silent."

Then she went to Japan and became the lightning. Whether or not she slept through the aftermath, India did not. Two golds flashed across the sky, and a sport that thought it knew its stars blinked in the glare.

THE GIST

- ▼ Chikitha is India's first double gold medalist at the 2026 Asian Games, triumphing in the women's compound team and mixed team events
- ▼ Chikitha and Sahil (mixed team) also helped secure India a quota for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics
- ▼ A Decathlon bow, shooting at haystacks in her backyard and YouTube tutorials were her first training ground, while lockdown and a snapped bowstring couldn't stop her
- ▼ Her father sold his harvester so his daughter could chase a target. In Aichi-Nagoya, she paid it back in gold
- ▼ When Abhishek failed to make the cut for the Asian Games, he told his mentee to become the Asian Games champion and bring him the toy as a gift. The 21-year-old now has two, with a chance to bid for a third in the individual event

T.V. Padma
NEW DELHI

The world faces a ‘narrowing window’ to restore forests essential to food security and the climate. A quiz on forests

A NASA spokesperson did not address questions for comment on the engine issue or its Artemis programme, instead pointing to a post on X from the head of the space agency, Jared Isaacman, saying Starship had “achieved an important milestone.”

NASA officially aims to return astronauts to the moon's surface by 2028, a target widely seen as overly ambitious, to get there ahead of China, which plans a crewed lunar landing by 2030.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount received by Mizoram under the Centre's schemes

75.79 in ₹ crore. Mizoram received ₹75.79 crore under central schemes to develop the agriculture sector of the State, an official statement said on Wednesday. Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan handed over the release orders to State Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister P.C. Vanlalruata in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

Community halls to be turned into Ayushman Arogya Mandirs

78 The Municipal Corporation of Delhi will set up Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (AyAMs) in its community halls across the capital to strengthen primary healthcare accessibility for local residents, officials said. Under the initiative led by the MCD's health department, 78 under-utilised civic halls will host primary health centres under the centrally sponsored scheme. PTI

Number of women executed in the U.S. since 1976

18 The U.S. state of Tennessee was set on Wednesday to execute a woman for the first time in 200 years, three decades after she murdered a classmate. Christa Pike, now 50, was 18 when she and her boyfriend beat and killed Colleen Slemmer, 19, at a job training camp for young people. In the United States, only 18 women have been executed since 1976, the Center says. AFP

Percentage decline in seaborne imports of motor fuels to Russia

24 in per cent. Seaborne imports of motor fuels to Russia fell by about 24% month-on-month in September to 350,000 metric tons, while Moscow continued to struggle with oil products shortages, sources said. The main bulk of seaborne fuel imports into Russian ports in September consisted of gasoline supplied from India, Morocco and Turkiye, traders said. REUTERS

Union government's fiscal deficit at the end of August

7.1 in ₹ lakh crore. The Union government's fiscal deficit stood at ₹7.1 lakh crore or 41.9% of the full-year target at the end of August, according to data released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA) on Wednesday. The deficit was at 38.1% of the Budget Estimates (BE) of 2025-26 during the corresponding period last year. PTI

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The significance of the Cardiff MoU

The Memorandum of Understanding signals growing demands for autonomy in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland, though their constitutional goals differ; it also calls for closer ties with the EU, putting pressure on Westminster to address their aspirations

WORLD INSIGHT

Joan Sony Cherian

In September 14, the First Ministers of Northern Ireland, Wales and Scotland came together in Cardiff, the capital city of Wales, to sign a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) and declared, “For the first time ever, people across these islands have First Ministers...who are all committed to independence from the United Kingdom. For people watching across these islands – for people watching around the world – there could be no clearer sign that Westminster’s time is coming to an end.” The MoU is being seen as a significant political statement by all three parties towards constitutional independence from the U.K.

The U.K. is often described as a multi-national state (or a State of Unions), developed gradually over several centuries. As per the Cabinet Office, the U.K. is comprised of four ‘nations’ – England, Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland.

The nations of Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland have strong cultural identities, their own language and customs as well as complicated histories vis-a-vis England, marked by conquests and rebellions. It is owing to such strong assertions of identity and independence that these nations within the U.K. have been granted varying degrees of self-government and devolved powers. However, calls for independence or an absolute devolution of powers have always remained in public discourse, and today, with the leaders of all three nations being vocal proponents of self-determination, the mandate has been brought to Westminster in full force.

However, independence does not look the same for all three nations; it’s characterised by their specific contexts, histories and geopolitical locations.

The Irish question

Northern Ireland is governed by a power-sharing agreement known as consociationalism, as laid down in the Good Friday Agreement of 1998. Considering the tumultuous history of violence between the pro-Irish (Nationalists or Republicans) and pro-Union (Loyalists or Unionists) groups, consociationalism mandates that power should be shared between all sectarian groups equally. Therefore, both the Nationalist and the Unionist blocs need to hold power together. After elections, the largest party in the largest political bloc will hold the position of First Minister, while the largest party in the second-largest political bloc can have the post of Deputy First Minister. Currently, Sinn Féin, the largest Nationalist party, is in power, with its Vice-President, Michelle O’Neill, leading the country.

However, pro-Irish groups in Northern Ireland and Sinn Féin do not wish for independence; they wish to unite with the Republic of Ireland. Owing to such strong sympathies, the Good Friday Agreement has a clause which keeps this option open – that the people of Northern Ireland could seek reunification with Ireland any time, subject to a referendum. However, a referendum can be called only by the U.K. Secretary of State for Northern Ireland if no other referendum has taken place in the past seven years or if the Secretary thinks that a majority of people wish to leave the U.K. and join Ireland.

The Unionists have strongly pushed



(From left) Scotland’s John Swinney, Wales’ Rhun ap Iorwerth, Sinn Féin’s Mary Lou McDonald and Northern Ireland’s Michelle O’Neill during a meeting, in Cardiff, on September 14. AP

back against the MoU. Emma Little-Pengelly, the Deputy First Minister, said the MoU was signed by Ms. O’Neill in her capacity as a leader of Sinn Féin and not as First Minister. It isn’t, she said, “on behalf of Northern Ireland”.

Scotland’s independence push

Many in Scotland, on the other hand, wish for it to become an independent country. Scotland voted for devolution in a 1997 referendum, and the Scottish Parliament was established in 1999. However, ever since the Scottish National Party (SNP) took power in the Holyrood (Scottish Parliament) in 2007, the demand for an absolute devolution of powers has been in the public discourse. The party had been consistently pushing for a referendum in Scotland on the question of independence, with one finally being held in 2014. While the referendum saw a massive turnout, the result was a major blow to the SNP; the Yes camp, which believed that Scotland should be independent, lost, receiving 44.7% of the votes. The No campaign won 55.3% of the total votes. While this led to a mild dampener for a period of time, the SNP, under Nicola Sturgeon, revived the demand again post-Brexit. She alleged that even though 62% of the Scottish people voted to remain in the European Union (EU), the U.K. left the alliance; this underlined the importance of self-determination for the Scottish people.

Currently, John Swinney, Prime Minister and leader of the SNP, upholds the same demand. While he advocated for the steady and gradual devolution of powers from Westminster when he first took the post of First Minister in 2024, the victory of pro-independence parties in the recent state elections, held in May 2026, has given Mr. Swinney and the SNP fresh hope. Together with the Scottish Green Party, the Holyrood now has 73 pro-independence members. Mr. Swinney has taken this to mean a shift in public opinion about the need for total devolution and has strongly pushed for mechanisms to hold a second referendum by 2031.

A shift in Wales

The strong stand taken by Wales in

signing the MoU is somewhat of a departure from its earlier position. The nation, a stronghold of the Labour Party for nearly a century, now has a non-Labour government led by Rhun ap Iorwerth, leader of Plaid Cymru. Plaid Cymru, established in 1925, has always held the ideal of self-determination at the centre of its political project. However, support for an independent Welsh nation has been a relatively minor position within the country as compared to Scotland. For example, the Welsh referendum in 1997, which was the first step to devolution of powers and the creation of a Welsh National Assembly, passed very narrowly with just 50.3% voting in favour of an Assembly as opposed to 49.7% who voted against the motion.

However, since then, the momentum for greater devolution from Westminster and more autonomy has been steadily gaining ground in the region. In the 2011 referendum, which was to decide whether the National Assembly for Wales should gain the power to legislate on a wider range of matters, the result was more promising with almost 63.49% voting yes for more powers as opposed to just 36.51% voting no.

The Labour Party, while being opposed to the idea of a total devolution of powers, has increasingly argued for more constitutional powers to Wales, especially regarding matters of policing and justice. In fact, in November 2021, the Labour-led Welsh government set up an Independent Commission on the Constitutional Future of Wales in order to seriously consider the possibility of an independent Wales along with other potential options such as enhanced devolution, and a more federal U.K. The Commission submitted its report in 2024 wherein it emphasised that the idea of an independent Wales cannot be kept out of popular imagination anymore even though it still does not enjoy as much as popular support as it does in Scotland. The report also underlined the possible “short-term to medium” risks especially with respect to currency, government finances, trade and movement across borders.

Therefore, Mr. Iorwerth’s positioning, even while signing the MoU at Cardiff with

Scotland and Northern Ireland, has been much more mellow than the other two regions. He has ruled out pushing for a referendum in his current term but has insisted that the possibility should be kept open; he stated that the people of Wales should have the option “to decide its own future”.

Response from Westminster

The U.K. Prime Minister Andy Burnham came to power riding on the agenda of more devolution of powers to local regions. He is a strong supporter of decentralisation; of giving more power to local governments and communities. In fact, in order to decentralise and shift power from central London, he has established a northern branch of 10, Downing Street in Manchester.

However, when Mr. Burnham visited Northern Ireland in August, he categorically stated that a border poll (referendum) on Irish unity was “off the table”. He said that his focus was to fix immediate crises such as the cost-of-living pressure and problems with public services. The reactions to his comments were sharp with nationalist parties taking it as a denouncement of the Good Friday Agreement. Sinn Féin’s president Mary Lou McDonald, who was the fourth signatory to the MoU, had stated that “We have the right to a referendum. We have the right to decide our future.... We will not accept or tolerate any Prime Minister telling us that right is off the table.”

The response to Scottish calls for a referendum have also been pretty much the same. When Mr. Swinney had written to Mr. Burnham, and asked if a mechanism for a referendum could be enshrined in law, Mr. Burnham stated that a Scottish border poll is currently “off-limits”.

The EU demand

Another significant aspect of the MoU was the call to reintegrate with the EU. The statement reads, “Brexit has damaged our economies, and limited opportunities for our people. Europe is our common home, and we believe the future of our nations belongs in the European Union”.

During the Brexit vote in 2016, Scotland (62%) and Northern Ireland (55%) had voted to remain. In Wales, roughly 52% voted to leave the EU, although a large minority voted to remain. All three governing parties are now resolute in their stance that the Brexit vote has been a total political failure. Even though a Trade and Cooperation Agreement has been signed with the EU, these nations allege that “non-tariff barriers” such as extra and time consuming paper work add to import and export delays.

However, reintegration would not be easy. Even if all three nations were to leave the U.K., reintegrating into the EU is a long process which could take years. For example, Montenegro has been in accession negotiations since 2012, and Serbia since 2014.

The Cardiff MoU is not a legal or multi-lateral treaty; it is a significant political statement by the governing parties of three regions, with varied histories, to put pressure on U.K.’s asymmetric federal model. Westminster’s constant refrain of ‘there are more important things to worry about’ gives these nations the idea that autonomy and devolution of powers is not seen as important enough by the U.K. Parliament. For a Prime Minister who has made decentralisation his central campaign, Mr. Burnham would be wise to pay more heed to the nations’ aspirations.

THE GIST

▼ Northern Ireland’s push is centred on reunification with Ireland, while Scotland is seeking independence and Wales is advocating greater autonomy, with the three nations’ positions shaped by their distinct political histories

▼ In Scotland and Wales, recent political developments have strengthened demands for greater powers, with Scotland pushing for a second independence referendum and Wales keeping the possibility of independence open while favouring further devolution

▼ Westminster has rejected immediate calls for referendums on Scottish independence and Irish reunification, while the three nations’ governments have criticised Brexit and called for closer integration with the European Union

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